

the hindu businessline

bl.portfolio

Deja vu.
Will the rally in
semicon stocks
sustain? History
has answers
BIG STORY P2

Moment of truth.
Health insurance
cover may not
play out in reality
as in theory
SAFE INVESTING P9

BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

Regd. TN/ARD/14/2012-2014, RNI No. 55320/94

How hot will the base metals be in 2026

UPSIDE AT RISK. While supply disruptions can support rally, possible interest rate hikes later in the year can halt the same

Gurumurthy K
bl, research bureau

Base metal prices have continued their strong rally in 2026 after posting stellar gains in 2025. The S&P/TSX Global Base Metals Index, which surged 49 per cent in 2025 — its strongest annual gain since 2016 — is currently at 380, up a further 33 per cent this year.

Among individual base metals, tin tops the chart, with prices rising about 36 per cent so far this year. It is followed by aluminium, up 22 per cent.

Copper, the best-performing base metal in 2025 with a 42 per cent gain, has advanced another 10 per cent in 2026. Copper prices touched a record high of \$14,527 per tonne on the London Metal Exchange (LME) in January.

EARLY TRIGGERS

A weaker US dollar and supply disruptions were the primary drivers of the base metals rally in 2025. The Dollar Index declined nearly 12 per cent, from a high of 110 in January to a low of 96.40 in July 2025, before



moving largely sideways for the remainder of the year.

Supply disruptions became a major support factor in the second half of 2025. For instance, copper supply was hit by an estimated 600,000-tonne disruption following an accident at Indonesia's Grasberg mine, one of the world's largest copper mines. The disruption accounted for roughly 3 per cent of global copper production.

Demand from China, particularly for copper and lead, also supported prices. "China rolled out several stimulus measures to revive economic growth, and that was one of the key factors

supporting base metal prices," said Saif Mukadam, Research Analyst, ICICI Direct.

STORY IN 2026

The supply disruption narrative has continued into 2026 following the US-Iran conflict. The closure of the Strait of Hormuz has intensified supply concerns, particularly for aluminium and copper.

Gulf countries account for about 9 per cent of global aluminium production. They also contribute nearly 50 per cent of global seaborne sulphur exports. Sulphur is a key input in copper production, making the

Performance report

Commodity	LME return (%)		MCX return (%)	
	2025	2026*	2025	2026*
Tin	39	36.6	-	-
Aluminium	17	22.4	22.7	30.0
Nickel	9	14.5	19.9	13.1
Zinc	5	13.6	10.4	18.5
Copper	42	9.8	62.0	5.0
Lead	3	0.2	2.8	13.1

LME - London Metal Exchange, 3 month rolling forward contract
MCX - Multi Commodity Exchange, Futures contract

*Year-to-date

metal vulnerable to supply-chain disruptions. For zinc, smelter closures in Peru, the world's second-largest producer, have also lent support to prices.

CLOUDED OUTLOOK

Unless tensions between the US and Iran ease, concerns over supply disruptions are likely to persist, keeping upward pressure on metal prices.

However, sustained high metal prices could eventually contribute to broader inflationary pressures, especially when combined with elevated energy costs.

As a result, the US Federal Reserve, under its new

Chairman Kevin Warsh, may be compelled to raise interest rates if inflation accelerates due to higher oil prices. Higher interest rates would support the dollar but could weigh on commodity prices.

"Metals thrive on cheaper money. Higher interest rates make borrowing more expensive, and that can slow demand for metals over time. That is one key concern," said Sunil Katke, Head - Commodities (Retail), Kotak Securities.

However, Sandeep Daga, Founder and CEO of Metal Intelligence Centre (MIC), cautioned that market participants are focussing ex-

cessively on supply disruptions while overlooking demand-side risks.

"Nobody is looking at the demand side of the equation. Chinese data show weak retail sales, slowing industrial production and construction activity, while growth in electric vehicles and solar power generation has turned negative," Daga said.

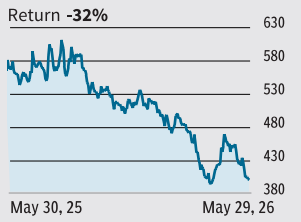
Indeed, the International Copper Study Group (ICSG) revised its 2026 outlook in April. The group now expects the copper market to end 2026 with a surplus of 96,000 tonnes, compared with its earlier forecast of a 150,000-tonne deficit.

ON THE CHARTS

Based on technical analysis, LME copper (\$13,636 per tonne) could form a top in the \$15,000-16,000 per tonne range. Immediate support is seen in the \$11,500-11,000 region.

LME aluminium has moved decisively above the key resistance level of \$3,400 per tonne.

As long as it remains above this level, the metal has the potential to rally towards \$4,000 per tonne.



INVESTMENT FOCUS.

Emami: Accumulate

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

FMCG major Emami's stock has fallen over 30 per cent in the last one year, bringing valuations to reasonable levels even as near-term business delivery remains uneven.

At 20.5 times one-year forward earnings and 18.6 times two-year forward earnings, the stock is now trading at a meaningful discount to its own history, with FY27-based price-to-earnings about 25 per cent below its five-year average. That valuation comfort matters at a time when the broader market remains overvalued.

The company also offers steady free cash flow generation (4-4.5 per cent of market capitalisation), a net cash-positive balance-sheet, improving traction in select non-summer product categories, and growth optionality from newer businesses.

Emami still has to prove that growth can become less dependent on the summer cycle and that weak patches in legacy brands can be offset by better execution elsewhere. The encouraging signs are visible in hair-care revival efforts, steady demand in pain management and healthcare offerings.

The stock may not see an immediate re-rating, but the current valuation leaves room for upside if management delivers even a modest improvement in volumes, category mix and cost discipline. Thus, investors with a four-five-year view and tolerance for interim volatility can accumulate the stock.

The key monitorables will be sustained volume recovery, margin protection despite brand spends, and whether new businesses can scale without diluting overall profitability.

FinMin report flags inflation pressures, risks to consumption demand as external environment worsens

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

A Finance Ministry report on Saturday warned of inflationary pressures building and headwinds to consumption demand, while calling for a mix of monetary, fiscal and structural policy measures to navigate uncertainties arising from geopolitical tensions.

"The current divergence between retail inflation and wholesale prices signals that upstream cost pressures are building, and the pass-through to consumers, while limited so far, may not be far behind," the *Monthly Economic Review* (MER), prepared by the Department of Economic Affairs, said.

Retail inflation, measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI), eased to 3.5 per cent in April, while wholesale inflation, based on the Wholesale Price Index (WPI), stood at 8.3 per cent.

PRICEY FUEL

The report noted that the inflation data preceded multiple rounds of fuel price hikes. "The recent hike in petrol and diesel prices may activate both direct and indirect transmission channels, and any further escalation in energy prices could narrow the existing cushion more quickly than anticipated," it said.

Petrol and diesel prices have been raised four times recently, by ₹7.38 and ₹7.52 per litre, respectively. Given

that the two fuels together account for about 5 per cent of the CPI basket, the increases could transmit the global energy price shock to retail inflation through both direct and indirect channels, the report said.

Apart from inflationary concerns, the report flagged risks to consumption demand.

A deficient monsoon could exacerbate food price pressures already being driven by higher energy costs.

'CAUTIOUS RESILIENCE'

"With forecasts pointing to a below-normal monsoon and a likely moderation in economic activity, overall consumption demand may face headwinds in the coming

months," it said.

On the broader economy, the report described the near-term outlook as one of "cautious resilience".

Domestic fundamentals remain broadly intact, with manufacturing and services PMIs staying in expansionary territory, labour market conditions remaining stable, and foreign exchange reserves providing a buffer against external shocks.

However, it cautioned that the global environment has become significantly more challenging since the onset of the West Asia conflict.

STRAIT OF HORMUZ

Elevated crude oil prices, tighter financial conditions and slowing growth across major economies pose risks

that India cannot entirely shield itself from.

Looking ahead, the report said the duration of disruptions in the Strait of Hormuz remains the single most critical factor for India's external sector and inflation outlook.

If normalisation occurs soon, conditions are in place for a broader recovery, supported by robust services exports and sustained investment commitments.

"Policy will need to remain agile across monetary, fiscal and structural dimensions to navigate this period of compounded uncertainty — external as well as climatic — while keeping medium-term growth objectives firmly in view," the report concluded.

QUARTER-CENTURY



FROM AP TO WALL STREET. Marking the 25th anniversary of Dr Reddy's Laboratories' listing on the New York Stock Exchange, Chairman Satish Reddy rang the closing bell at the NYSE on Friday. Senior executives of the company joined him for the ceremony NYSE

FPIs turn net sellers for 3rd straight month in May

Anupama Ghosh
Mumbai

Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) remained net sellers in Indian equities for the third consecutive month in 2026, with net outflows of ₹32,963 crore in May, according to National Securities Depository Limited (NSDL) data.

The pace of selling, however, showed signs of moderating in the final week of May. NSDL data for the four trading sessions ended May 29 presented a mixed picture.

On May 25, FPIs recorded a net outflow of ₹6,176.80 crore across segments. The trend reversed the next day, with net inflows of ₹2,564.20 crore. Selling resumed on May 27, when FPIs pulled out ₹1,330.07 crore, before the month closed with a marginal net inflow of ₹502.06 crore on May 29, indicating tentative stabilisation.

In equities, the week ended on a positive note. Net

Per NSDL data, foreign investors sold equities worth ₹60,847 crore in April and ₹1,17,775 crore in March

equity investment stood at ₹1,505.22 crore on May 29, following inflows of ₹2,194.68 crore on May 26. These gains partially offset outflows of ₹1,029.89 crore on May 27 and ₹5,259.31 crore on May 25, the steepest single-day equity withdrawal of the week.

DEBT: MIXED TREND

The debt market continued to reflect caution. In the Debt-VRR segment, FPIs were net sellers through the week, with the sharpest outflow of ₹976.41 crore on May 29.

FPI selling has been rising significantly through 2026. According to NSDL data, foreign investors sold equities worth ₹60,847 crore in

April and ₹1,17,775 crore in March, the largest monthly outflow so far this year. February briefly bucked the trend with net inflows of ₹22,615 crore, while January saw outflows of ₹35,962 crore. Total net FPI outflows from Indian equities in 2026 have now reached ₹2,24,932 crore. This was partly offset by ₹15,497 crore of inflows through the primary market route.

According to Prashant Shah, Co-founder and CEO of Definedequities Securities, "Between January and April, FPIs pulled out nearly ₹2-lakh crore from Indian equities, already exceeding the total outflows recorded during the whole of 2025. Bond flows also remained negative, though the magnitude was lower than in equities."

Analysts attributed the sustained selling to a combination of geopolitical and macroeconomic pressures.

"The primary catalyst for this large-scale withdrawal has been escalating geopolitical tensions in West Asia, which have heightened

global uncertainty and risk aversion. This has been compounded by macroeconomic pressures such as a weakening rupee and elevated crude oil prices," said Pabitra Mukherjee, Deputy Vice-President - Technical, Bajaj Broking.

DIIs: CUSHION

VK Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist at Geojit Investments, said, "Poor earnings growth in India, much stronger earnings growth in countries such as the US, Japan, South Korea and Taiwan, along with the strong AI-related trade in these markets, contributed significantly to FPI selling in India." Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs), meanwhile, continued to provide a strong counterbalance to foreign selling.

Mukherjee noted that DIIs infused ₹82,668 crore during May, more than offsetting the ₹55,963 crore of FPI outflows. "DIIs maintained a flawless buying streak every single day," he said.

Eateries, theatres, airlines pad up for IPL final

Restaurants, multiplexes have special deals to capitalise on cricket's biggest night

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

Restaurants and multiplexes are trying to lure cricket buffs from their sofas and couches on Super Sunday going all out to organise screening parties for the Royal Challengers versus Gujarat Titans IPL 2026 final clash.

PVR INOX is screening the IPL final at over 100 screens across the country. The chain said that audiences will be able to watch the match in high-definition on giant cinema screens with advanced surround sound and specially designed snack combos and cricket-viewing favourites for an enhanced match-day experience.

Interest is high, says Gautam Dutta, CEO - Revenue & Operations, PVR INOX Ltd. "We have seen very strong advance book-



SUPER SUNDAY. Artists and citizens paint a community wall mural for RCB ahead of the IPL 2026 final cricket match, in Bengaluru

ing trends for the final match. We anticipate occupancies to be over 80 per cent with many screens expected to be sold out."

SIXES AND SNACKS

Restaurants, pubs, food delivery and quick commerce platforms are all in on the cricket party doling out special offers. Restaurateurs said they anticipate higher footfalls on May 31 compared to average Sunday de-

mand trends.

Divya Aggarwal, Chief Growth Officer at Impresario Entertainment & Hospitality Pvt Ltd, behind brands such as SOCIAL and Smoke House Delhi, said curated ordering options will be available.

"We are expecting a 5-10 per cent increase in footfalls on Sunday. Cricket is a shared emotion. Fans not only look for a place to watch the game, they also

seek the energy of being surrounded by other fans to feel they are part of something larger," she added.

A senior restaurant executive said that over the years, the T20 league has emerged as a key consumption occasion for food aggregator platforms led by QSR brands that see higher number of delivery orders.

FANS AND FLIGHTS

Meanwhile, Akasa Air said it has ramped up connectivity to Ahmedabad with special flights from Bengaluru and Navi Mumbai on May 31 and June 1, in addition to its scheduled direct services from nine domestic and international destinations. Also, the Western Railway has introduced two special-fare trains between Mumbai and Ahmedabad in response to higher demand from passengers ahead of the finals.

Aarati Krishnan

Since 2024, Indian investors have enjoyed a pleasant honeymoon with inflation. Good monsoons and low crude oil prices have meant that CPI (Consumer Price Index) inflation has stayed well below 4 per cent mark in this period. Thanks to the Iran conflict, this situation is now set to change. Irrespective of whether the Trump ‘deal’ is struck or not, a portion of the global oil and gas capacity has been damaged by the war. The closure of Hormuz has disrupted shipping routes and supply chains, which may take months to normalise. Global prices of petroleum, gas and their derivative products are not fully reflecting these disruptions yet, as floating inventories have helped alleviate shortages. But now, with oil companies beginning to announce successive price hikes, the impact of supply chain breaks beginning to show up, and a looming El Nino set to fire up food prices, India’s inflation rates look likely to spike again. History has shown that spikes in inflation, driven by multiple triggers, do not fade away quickly and last a while. We should also be open to the possibility that this could be mean reversion playing out, as India’s long-term CPI inflation rate has averaged 6 per cent. Therefore, how should you as an investor prepare for this reversal? Where should you invest to beat higher inflation? Let’s take stock.

GOLD: LESS OF A HEDGE IN SHORT TERM

Theoretically, gold is supposed to be a good hedge against inflation because it preserves its value against paper money. This is true in the long run. But gold has proved an ineffectual hedge against inflation in the short term. Since the Iran war began, global gold prices are down 14 per cent in dollar terms. In India, rupee depreciation has cushioned this fall. However, gold prices are still down some 2 per cent since the war began, after rising 65 per cent in the year before. This strange behaviour of gold is underpinned by two factors. One, this conflict by disrupting global trade, has prompted some central banks to sell gold to help their nations tide over their tight finances (Russia, Türkiye). Two, the risk of rising inflation has caused global



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

yields on treasuries (government bonds) to spike. Treasuries compete directly with gold as safe-haven options for global investors. Therefore, when treasury yields improve, gold gets sold off by global investors. In recent years, gold prices have been influenced a lot by treasury yields, preventing gold from acting as a good inflation hedge. As an investor, you should still hold gold as a good portfolio hedge against geopolitical risks and equity volatility. But you should not look to gold to protect against short spells of high inflation. DEBT: SHORTER THE BETTER If there’s one set of investors who are clear losers from rising inflation, it is those who have locked into fixed interest on bonds or de-

FULL MENU

- Debt options: Floating rate bonds and debt funds, money market funds, ultra-short duration funds
- Equities: Choose firms with pricing power
- Gold: Good portfolio hedge against geopolitical risks and equity volatility

posits. While their interest income remains unchanged until maturity, inflation eats into the real returns that they take home. A spike in inflation also raises the possibility of rate hikes leading to capital losses on bonds. If you are a debt investor

though, there are some options that help you benefit from rising inflation (and thus rates). One, you can buy floating rate bonds. The Government of India’s Floating Rate Savings Bond (interest rates are pegged to a 0.35 per cent spread over the National Savings Certificate) is one good option. The interest rate on this bond is today at 8.05 per cent and can improve further if returning inflation leads to higher rates. Two, there are some categories of debt mutual funds which help you piggyback on rising rates. Floating rate debt funds, which use swaps to mimic floating rates, are one option. Money market mutual funds, which invest in treasury bills and other safe instruments with under one-year maturity, are another. Ultra-short duration

funds, which stick to corporate and government bonds with three- to six-month maturity, are a third option. In a rising inflation scenario where policy rates are yet to be hiked, bonds, deposits and mutual funds with more than one-year maturity are best avoided, as they deliver negative real returns. EQUITIES: SELECTIVE GAINS Theory has it that equities are the only asset class that can convincingly beat inflation in the long run. This is so for three reasons. One, when inflation rises, the economy’s nominal growth picks up, lifting corporate revenues. Two, rising inflation lifts salaries and wages, stoking spending. Three, the *raison d’etre* for equities is to deliver a gain to the business

owner over and above the cost of debt. Therefore, in the long run, equity returns are bound to outdo debt. However, when we get down to practise, the reality is more nuanced. When input inflation suddenly rears its head, companies face immediate margin pressures. Their ability to grow their profits during spells of rising inflation, therefore, depends on their pricing power — the extent to which they are able to pass on inflated costs to their end-consumers. In today’s context, Q4 FY26 results showed companies reporting healthy operating margins even as topline recovered. This was because, in this quarter, companies were benefiting from rising end-product prices, while they used up their existing raw material inventories. The current quarter may offer the real test of what happens when input cost inflation begins to pinch corporate profit margins. Therefore, when choosing stocks and sectors to buy today, it is critical to look for companies that have pricing power. Experience suggests that companies operating in duopolistic or oligopolistic sectors, those with wide brand or distribution moats, sector leaders with dominant market share and companies that have a services component in their revenue mix, have the most pricing power. The other way to hedge against an inflation spike and actually make money from it, it to bet directly on companies churning out commodities whose prices are rising. As commodity cycles are hard to decipher, this is best done through commodity ETFs (exchange traded funds) or international funds which own a basket of commodities. Passive funds playing on the Nifty Commodities Index, which has a mix of energy, metal, chemical and cement companies, are one option. There are also a few interesting funds on the international menu that offer a direct play on commodities. DSP World Mining Overseas Equity Fund and ICICI Pru Strategic Metal and Energy Equity are some funds to explore.

PNB launches collateral-free loans

ALERTS. Annuity surrender norms PFRDA has now permitted the surrender of annuity policies in specific cases. Annuities can be surrendered in the event of a critical illness affecting the annuitant or their family members, subject to the Annuity Service Provider’s (ASP) standard assessment process. Also, annuities issued before October 24, 2024, can be surrendered if the original policy document contains an explicit surrender clause. The surrender can only be processed after the annuitant gives explicit written consent regarding the final proceeds.



Punjab National Bank (PNB) has officially launched its “DIGI PNB SHRAM SAATHI” scheme, offering collateral-free, end-to-end digital loans up to ₹1 lakh for existing account holders who serve as community-based frontline workers. The scheme aims to drive financial inclusion for skilled, semi-skilled and unskilled workforce segments at major enterprises like BHEL, GAIL, SAIL and ONGC. To qualify, gainfully employed individuals must be at least 21 years old with a total annual household income up to ₹3 lakh. Loan limits range from ₹10,000 to ₹1 lakh, carrying an 11 per cent interest rate. The bank will waive margin requirements, processing fees, and documentation charges.

The author is a Contributing Editor

TAX QUERY.

SUDHAKAR SETHURAMAN For completeness of understanding on the tax treatment of NPS Tier II on withdrawal (bl.portfolio edition dated May 24), what is the tax treatment of a one-way switch from NPS Tier II to Tier I? Dr Shraman Jha



GETTY IMAGES

One-way switch from NPS Tier II to Tier I will be regarded as redemption of units in Tier II, followed by a fresh investment into Tier I. The Income-Tax provisions currently do not

provide a specific exemption for inter-scheme transfer/switch from Tier II to Tier I. Hence this would attract taxation. Accordingly, at the time of switch, the appreciation

in the Tier II units shall be liable to capital gains tax in the same manner as a normal withdrawal from Tier II. The characterisation as short-term or long-term capital gains would depend

on the holding period of the Tier II units being switched. The tax treatment broadly remains similar as below: Units held for more than 24 months would qualify as long-term capital assets and gains would be taxable at 12.5 per cent (without indexation). Units held for 24 months or less would result in short-term capital gains taxable at the applicable slab rates. The writer is Partner, Deloitte India

thehindubusinessline. Classifieds BUSINESS OFFER BUSINESS FOR SALE MODULAR STEEL Lab Furniture manufacturing company at Chennai. Interested contact Mr.R.Ramakrishnan 9445560901. All technical and commercial details shall be given including Marketing Supports. RENTAL COMMERCIAL 2400 SQ. ft Area Newly Constructed Commercial Property, First Floor with Lift and Parking Space Available in Gandhipuram, 10th Street in Coimbatore. Contact: 9944199944 To advertise visit www.thehinduads.com Toll Free: 1800 102 4161

GSB FINANCE LIMITED CIN: L99999MH2001PLC134193 | GSTIN: 27AACG0914E1Z3 Registered Office: 201, 2nd Floor, Eco Space I.T. Park Building, Village Mogra, Old Nagardas Road, Andheri (E) Mumbai (MH) - 400069. Corporate Office: 301, 2nd Floor, Eskay Plaza, Anand Talkies Road, Raipur (CG) - 492001. Tel: 0771-4210000 | e-mail: compliance@gsbfinance.com | Website: https://gsbfinance.com/ AUDITED STANDALONE FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED 31ST MARCH 2026 The Audited Standalone Financial Results of GSB Finance Limited for the Quarter and year ended 31st March 2026 have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors at their respective meeting held on Friday, 29th May 2026. The Financial Results along with the Auditors Report can be accessed at Company's website at https://gsbfinance.com/quarterly-results/ and on the website of Stock Exchange i.e. https://www.bseindia.com/. The same can also be accessed by scanning the QR code provided along side: For, GSB Finance Limited Akshat Sharma Company Secretary

MALANKARA PLANTATIONS LIMITED CIN: L66000KL1910PLC000650 Estd:1910 GSTIN:32AABCT2019A1ZB Regd. Office: Malankara Buildings, Kodimatha (Post Box No. 72) Kottayam – 686013, Kerala, India Tel:91-481-2568360, 91-481-2568335, E-mail: malankaraplantations@gmail.com, www.malankaraplantations.co.in AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS The Board of Directors of the Company, at their Meeting held On May 29, 2026, approved the Audited financial results of the Company, for the Quarter and Financial year ended March 31, 2026 The results, along with the Audited Report issued by the Statutory Auditors, have been posted on the Company's website at www.malankaraplantations.co.in and can also be accessed by scanning the following Quick Response Code. For Malankara Plantations Limited Sd/- Bibin Cheriyan Company Secretary & Compliance officer Date: 29.05.2026 Place: Kottayam Note: The above intimation is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(1) of the SEBI (Listing Obligation & Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

Jinkushal Industries Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results for the Quarter and Year ended March 31, 2026 The audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results of Jinkushal Industries Limited ("the Company") along with the Audit Report of the Statutory Auditors of the Company for the quarter and year ended on March 31, 2026 have been reviewed by the Audit Committee and approved by the Board of Directors of the Company at their Meetings held on May 29, 2026, in terms of Regulation 33 of SEBI (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The results along with the Audit Report have been posted on the Company's website at https://www.jkipl.in/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/JKIPL-Financial-Results-March-2026.pdf and on stock exchanges website www.nseindia.com and www.bseindia.com, respectively. The results can also be accessed by scanning the QR Code. For and on behalf of the Board of Directors of Jinkushal Industries Limited Mr. Anil Kumar Jain Chairman & Director DIN: 00679518 Note: The above information is in accordance with Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47(1) of SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations 2015.

KERALA INFRASTRUCTURE INVESTMENT FUND BOARD (A Statutory Body under Finance Department, Government of Kerala) Finance and Administration Division website: www.kiifb.org Defining the Future STATEMENT OF AUDITED STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE FINANCIAL YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026 The Audited Standalone and Consolidated Financial Results of Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board (KIIFB) for the Financial Year ended March 31, 2026 (Financial Results) reviewed and recommended by the Audit Committee on May 21, 2026 have been approved by the Board Members at their meeting held on May 30, 2026. The Financial Results along with the Limited Review Report are available on the website of KIIFB under Compliance Tab at: https://www.kiifb.org/resources.jsp and on the website of BSE at: www.bseindia.com. The same can also be accessed by scanning the Quick Response Code (QR Code) as provided below: For Kerala Infrastructure Investment Fund Board Sd/- Mini Antony Chief Executive Officer (In-Charge) Place: Trivandrum 2nd Floor, Felicity Square, M.G.Road, Statue, Thiruvananthapuram – 695001 Phone: 0471-2780900 to 914, e-mail: financeadmin@kiifb.org

Credit bets with equity flexibility

FUND CALL. SBI Conservative Hybrid Fund mixes active duration management with a relatively higher-yielding debt strategy

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl, research bureau

Conservative hybrid funds are aimed at investors seeking relatively-lower volatility than equity-heavy funds, while retaining limited equity exposure for potential upside.

In line with regulatory mandate, these schemes invest predominantly in debt, with a smaller equity allocation.

They may be less volatile than pure equity funds while potentially offering returns higher than traditional fixed-income avenues.

The category may appeal to cautious investors and savers with medium-term goals of three-five years who are unwilling to take sharp equity-market swings.

Within the category, SBI Conservative Hybrid Fund follows a relatively higher-yielding debt strategy than many of its peers.

Unlike most peers that largely stick to high-quality sovereign and AAA-rated papers, the fund tactically combines active duration calls with a meaningful allocation to AA-rated debt instruments.

This can increase the interest income earned by the portfolio (accrual income), but it also exposes investors to greater credit risk if an issuer's ability to repay weakens.

The fund has generally maintained close to 25 per cent in equity and 75 per cent in debt across market cycles.



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

duration bonds and relying more on regular interest income from its debt investments.

HIGH-YIELD OPPORTUNITY
A key source of additional yield is the fund's exposure to corporate bonds rated below AAA. These currently make up about 35 per cent of the portfolio and may rise to 45 per cent when the manager sees opportunities. The strategy seeks to earn the extra yield offered by corporate bonds over government securities, in return for taking higher issuer risk.

Of the total portfolio, about 10 per cent is in AA+ rated bonds, 17 per cent in AA-rated bonds and 8 per cent in AA- and lower-rated papers. A few names in the AA and below segments include GMR Airports, Avanse Financial Services, Infopark Properties, JTPM Metal Traders and Aditya Birla Renewables. According to the latest portfolio, AAA-rated bonds accounted for 24 per cent of assets, while government securities accounted for 7 per cent.

The other funds in the category that hold material non-AAA exposure include Nippon India Conservative Hybrid (54 per cent as of April 2026) and ICICI Pru Regular Savings (42 per cent).

FLEXI-CAP STRATEGY
The equity portfolio is measured against the BSE 500. It typ-

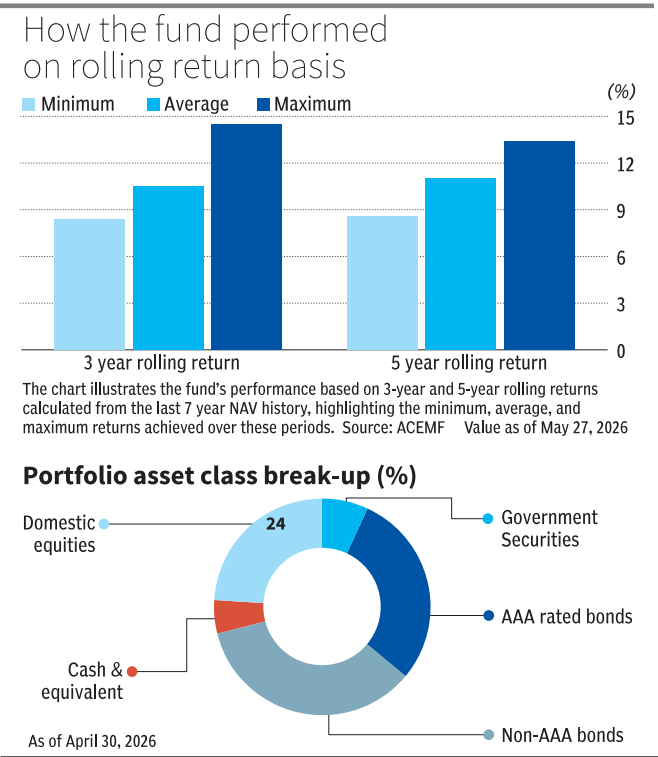


WHY INVEST?

- Flexi-cap-oriented equity allocation
- Ranked in the top two quartiles across most time-frames in bl.portfolio MF Ratings
- Suitable for investors comfortable with moderate credit and equity risk

ically holds around 40 stocks and can invest across large-, mid- and small-cap companies. The fund's equity strategy aims to identify stocks with strong earnings potential, robust financials, high governance standards and sound ESG profiles.

The fund's large-cap exposure can range between 30 per cent and 100 per cent of the equity portion, mid-cap expos-



ure between 0 and 70 per cent, and small-cap exposure between 0 and 50 per cent. On an average, over the past five years, the fund has allocated around 10 per cent of its total assets to large-caps, 6 per cent to mid-caps and 8 per cent to small-caps.

Currently, the equity portfolio has a strong small-cap tilt, with exposure close to the fund's stated upper limit of 50 per cent of its equity portion.

According to the manager, recent corrections have created stock-specific opportunities in small-caps after sharp declines in several companies.

Large-cap exposure remains near the lower end of the fund's mandated range at around 32 per cent of the equity portion, while mid-caps account for the remaining portion. As of April 2026, the large-, mid-, and small-cap allocations stood at 8 per cent, 4 per cent, and 12 per cent of the total assets, respectively.

The equity allocation is currently fully invested, with the fund maintaining close to the maximum permissible 25 per cent equity exposure and negligible cash holdings on the equity side.

PERFORMANCE
Over five-year rolling periods observed during the past seven years, the fund delivered an average annualised return of 11 per cent, against 9 per cent for the category. During these five-year rolling periods, annualised returns ranged from 8.6 per cent to 13.4 per cent. Across three-year rolling periods, the fund delivered an average annualised return of 10.5 per cent, against the category average of 8.8 per cent.

As of April 2026, the debt portfolio's yield to maturity, an indicative yield assuming securities are held to maturity and repayments occur as scheduled, was 8 per cent, against the category average of 7.4 per cent.

The expense ratio for the regular plan is 1.5 per cent, slightly below the category average of 1.6 per cent. However, its direct plan expense ratio is 1.07 per cent, above the category average of 0.84 per cent.

Given its sizeable exposure to lower-rated debt and its small-cap tilt within equities, the fund may suit investors willing to accept moderate credit and equity risk, with an investment horizon of at least five years.

ALERTS.

Kotak MF launches Nifty Alpha Low Volatility 30 Index Fund

Kotak Mahindra Mutual Fund has launched Kotak Nifty Alpha Low Volatility 30 Index Fund, an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking the Nifty Alpha Low-Volatility 30 Index.



The NFO closes on June 12. The entry load is not applicable and exit load is nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹1,000 and any amount thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked against Nifty Alpha Low-Volatility 30 Index (TRI) and its fund managers are Devender Singhal, Satish Dondapati and

Mahindra Manulife MF launches MPOWER SIF

Mahindra Manulife Mutual Fund has launched 'MPOWER SIF' and marking its entry into Specialised Investment Fund (SIF). The SIF category offers strategies that go beyond conventional mutual funds, including long-short approaches, derivatives-based strategies and more focused portfolio construction, catering to investors seeking a different approach to meeting their investment goals.



ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

ETF	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
	as on May 29			
ETF				
MOSL Nasdaq Q50 ETF	120.0	141.5	4.3	133
Groww BSE Power ETF	12.6	12.7	4.0	35,896
ABSL Nifty 200 Momtum 30	30.8	31.6	3.1	406
UTI BSE Sensex Next 50 ETF	91.4	92.2	2.8	19
Kotak Nifty MNC ETF	33.3	33.6	2.7	449
SBI Nifty Next 50 ETF	759.3	763.2	2.6	178
HDFC Nifty Next 50 ETF	72.5	72.7	2.3	318
GOLD ETFs				
Zerodha Gold ETF	24.5	24.5	-1.1	42,767
Angel One Gold ETF	14.5	14.5	-1.3	1,828
Edelweiss Gold ETF	155.1	155.6	-1.3	1,245

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on May 29, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on May 29	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	52.5	11.8	11.5	13.3	76,458
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	72.6	13.4	12.6	13.2	28,177
Kotak Pension Fund	65.4	12.2	12.1	13.0	4,533
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.7	6.1	5.8	8.3	8,645
SBI Pension Fund	41.0	6.1	5.7	7.7	28,714
HDFC Pension Fund	28.1	5.8	5.5	7.6	51,638
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	30.1	7.4	6.6	8.2	33,770
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.3	7.3	6.4	8.0	13,416
SBI Pension Fund	45.5	7.2	6.4	7.9	15,231
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	45.5	11.9	11.6	13.4	1,834
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	57.2	13.1	12.5	13.2	791
Kotak Pension Fund	57.5	12.2	12.1	12.9	220

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on May 29, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	250	11.2	23.2	22.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	853	6.1	19.5	17.3
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	6.6	20.4	16.2
Renaissance Investment Managers	Opportunities Portfolio	NA	-3.9	12.6	15.6
MULTI CAP					
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	117	9.4	29.1	26.1
Stallion Asset	Core Fund	6,992	12.3	37.6	25.1
Samvitti Capital	PMS Active Alpha Multicap	434	12.1	28.4	24.5
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	17.8	30.8	24.5
ICICI Pru	Value Strategy	1,096	16.2	26.2	24.2
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	6.2	21.0	24.2
MID-CAP					
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	9.7	17.5	18.0
Sundaram Alternate Assets	Self Portfolio	NA	35.1	24.4	17.5
Eureka PMS	Signature Approach	NA	7.0	21.3	16.8
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	3.6	16.0	16.5
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	3,592	40.0	42.0	41.8
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	895	2.6	23.0	36.4
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,278	0.8	31.8	26.3
Accuracap	Dynamo	NA	14.9	29.8	23.6

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on April 30, 2026

Third-party payment in MFs: Good or bad?

BL EXPLAINER. SEBI considers salary-linked investing, unit-based distributor commissions & donations via schemes

bl.explainer

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

Your mutual fund (MF) investments currently have to be paid for from your own bank account. Regulator SEBI is now considering a relaxation to this rule. In a consultation paper issued on May 20, it has proposed allowing third-party payments in specific situations, including investments made through salary deductions, commission paid to MF distributors in units and donations routed via MFs.

Here is a lowdown.

What is SEBI trying to do through its consultation paper on enabling third-party payments in MFs?

Currently, MF investments have to be paid for from the investor's own bank account. SEBI is now considering whether this rule can be relaxed in a few limited situations where another party makes the payment, but the investment still belongs to, or benefits, an identified investor or beneficiary.

The consultation paper proposes allowing third-party payments in three cases:

- * An employer deducts money from an employee's salary and invests it in MF schemes chosen by that employee.
 - * An AMC pays trail commissions to a MF distributor in the form of MF units instead of cash.
 - * Contributions or donations are channelled towards social causes through MFs.
- SEBI is thus not proposing a free-for-all in third-party payments. It is examining whether specific, traceable relationships, such as that between an employer and employee, can be permitted as limited exceptions without weakening safeguards against fraud, money laundering or misuse of investor accounts.

What do the existing rules specify regarding this?

Under the present framework, the money used to buy MF units must come directly from the investor's own bank account. Payments must also move through permitted channels, such as RBI-authorised payment aggregators or SEBI-recognised clearing corporations.

In regulatory terms, this creates a closed loop — the investor, the source of the investment money and the recipient of the redemption proceeds are linked through verified bank accounts. A third-party payment breaks this link at the investment stage, which is why the present framework takes a conservative approach.

The rule helps the MF system establish whose money is being invested, trace the payment route and ensure that redemption proceeds are paid only into verified bank accounts. These safeguards are intended to reduce fraud and money-laundering risks and support compliance with the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

Competing products such as insurance already allow third-party payments.

How will paying for MF units through employer help investors?

Under the proposal, an eligible employer could deduct an amount from an employee's salary and make a consolidated payment to an AMC for investment in MF schemes selected by the employee.

The facility would be voluntary. Only employees who opt for it would participate, and they would choose their preferred schemes. It would also not be available through every employer. According to the consultation paper, the facility would be restricted to listed companies, EPFO-registered companies and AMCs themselves.



GETTY IMAGES

● BROADER GOAL

The proposal is aimed at making genuine transactions easier while retaining checks against fraud and money laundering

For employees, the proposed advantage is mainly convenience rather than access to a new investment product. They can already invest in MFs on their own. What changes is that regular investing could be embedded in the salary process, rather than requiring the employee to separately initiate payments from his or her bank account.

A key investor-interest question is whether such payroll-routed investments would be made in Direct Plans or Regular Plans. If the employee is choosing the scheme and the employer is merely facilitating the salary deduction, routing such investments through Regular Plans could mean the employee bears distribution-related costs despite not receiving distributor-led advice.

After the initial choice, MF investments may need periodic course correction in the case of poor performance. Freedom to change schemes should be available to employees in a hassle-free manner.

Another point to consider is the feasibility of having another salary-linked investment for employees. EPF contributions already take up a portion of the employees' salaries. In other cases, there is the NPS. It can be argued that not many employees can find room for another automated saving option, unless they create space by organising existing monthly investments.

What are the challenges likely to be?

Allowing a third party to pay for an investor's MF units creates a key regulatory concern. The person funding the investment is different from the person who owns the units. This raises risks around tracing the source of funds, preventing money laundering and fraud, and avoiding conflicts of interest or mis-selling.

For instance, an employer facilitating salary-linked investments could favour schemes of an affiliated AMC. Similarly, SEBI explicitly flags that allowing an AMC to pay trail commissions to distributors in MF units could create a conflict of interest, potentially leading to mis-selling.

SEBI has, therefore, proposed safeguards such as robust KYC checks (with clearly defined responsibilities for both AMCs and RTAs), clear written man-

dates, electronic fund transfers, segregated accounts, regular reconciliation and a traceable audit trail.

Beyond SEBI's stated regulatory concerns, a practical operational risk is that the payroll route could also expose employees to a familiar salary-deduction risk. This means situations where money is being withheld from employee pay without timely allotment of the intended MF units. Since MFs are market-linked, delayed or incorrect allotment could also result in an adverse NAV impact, unless the final framework clearly fixes responsibility and compensation.

However, the proposals are still at the consultation stage. The detailed operating safeguards are to be specified by AMFI in consultation with SEBI, and the final framework may differ from what is presently outlined.

Some are calling it India's 401(k) moment. Is this right?

Not quite, at least not yet. SEBI's proposal could make MF investing more convenient by allowing employees to route investments through salary deductions. In that limited sense, it introduces a workplace-linked investing channel.

But salary deduction alone does not make an investment facility a retirement system. It only changes how the investment is funded. A 401(k)-type framework is about the broader architecture of retirement savings, including its retirement purpose, incentives, the employer's role and the rules governing accumulation and withdrawal.

The consultation paper does not propose a dedicated retirement product or specify tax incentives for employees or employers. Seen this way, SEBI is proposing a change in the plumbing of MF investing, not yet building a new retirement savings architecture.

Steeled for future growth

STEEL. JSW Steel’s improved operating metrics, higher capacity and lighter balance-sheet will be the drivers

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

In its Q4FY26 results announcement, JSW Steel outlined plans to nearly double its capacity by FY32, accelerating its expansion strategy through a combination of brownfield and greenfield projects, joint ventures and acquisitions to strengthen supply-chain security. The resolution of BPSL (Bhushan Power and Steel) has materially improved the company’s leverage profile, and the management intends to maintain healthy debt levels while executing its sizeable ₹1.26-lakh crore capital expenditure plan over the next five years.

We had recommended that investors accumulate the stock in June 2024 when it was trading at 10.7 times one-year forward EV/EBITDA, and the stock has since delivered a 40 per cent return. Given the similarly positive growth outlook, stronger operating metrics, with improved leverage this time, and the stock continuing to trade at comparable valuation levels of 10.7 times EV/EBITDA, we reiterate our accumulate rating. But considering the geopolitical volatility in the current times, investors should look for a margin of safety in valuations and should accumulate the stock on corrections owing to macroeconomic uncertainty.

OPERATING METRICS

JSW Steel’s sales realisations grew 5.5 per cent year on year in Q4FY26, the first quarter of growth since Q2FY23. Owing to excess imports from China and Vietnam, domestic steel prices were under pressure in the last few years. In April 2025, India applied safeguard duties of 11-12 per cent for the next three years, which has aided domestic steel prices. As Europe applies CBAM from 2026, a form of duties on carbon-intensive production like steel, international prices of steel are also expected to be elevated. With a dual impact of safeguard duties and improved international prices, domestic steel prices are expected to sustain the year-on-year growth in FY27.



● **ACCUMULATE ON DIPS**

JSW Steel ₹1,277.70

WHY

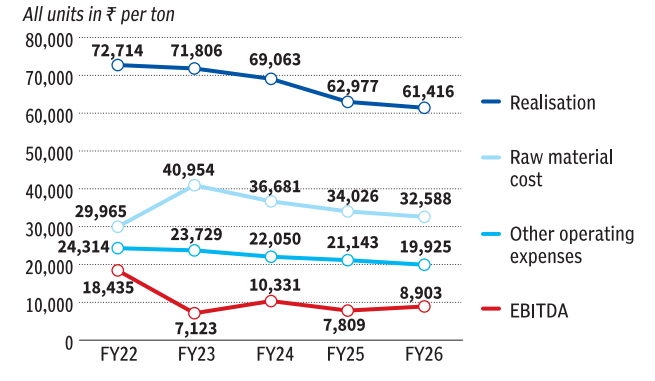
- Strengthened balance sheet
- Improved realisations to counter rising coal prices
- High capex outlay

The falling realisations in the last four years were buffered by lower raw material costs, primarily of coking coal, and power and fuel. As shown in the table, the EBITDA per tonne has declined but aided by lower raw material costs, the decline was limited. But raw material cost, primarily of coking coal, is increasing now which can partially offset the improved realisations from here. The other costs of power and fuel are expected to improve as low-cost renewable energy is being added. The company plans on 3.5 GW of RE power by FY31-32. The West Asian crisis has had a very limited impact on JSW Steel, as LNG was utilised in smaller amounts at a few facilities which can be managed, as per the company. Overall EBITDA per tonne should improve marginally from here.

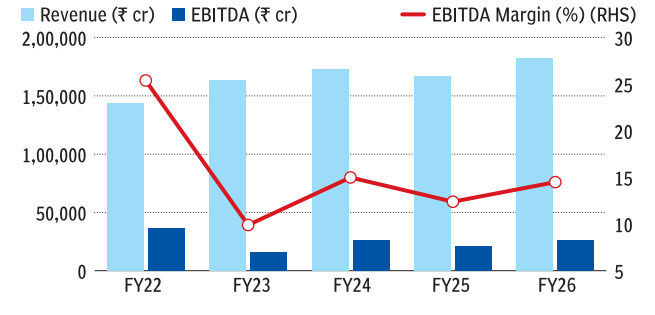
CAPACITY EXPANSION

The company expects to have an installed capacity of 79.5 mtpa (million tonnes per annum) by FY32 (including JVs) from 37.9 mtpa currently, which is a 13 per cent CAGR volume growth on execution. The company expects strong demand for steel in India

Costs and realisations decline offsetting each other



Financial performance



Source: Company presentation Q4FY26

(8-9 per cent) in the next few years supported by GDP growth, high infra building stage at the central level and demand from auto/construction segments. Indian steel demand has grown at 11 per cent CAGR in the last five years to 163 mtpa in FY26.

As shown in the table, the current capacity includes 31.9 mtpa in India, 1.5 mtpa in Ohio (the US) and 4.5 mtpa in JSW JFE – a 50:50 JV created to house BPSL assets after the slump-sale to a joint venture entity with Japan’s JFE Steel Corporation in FY26. From here, the company has already added 0.9 mtpa in FY27 so far by way of an acquisition (BMM Ispat at an EV of ₹6,400 crore), which is close to JSW Vijayanagar facility in Karnataka. The company will be adding 5 mtpa each in Dolvi by September 2027, Utkal and Vijayanagar by FY30. All of which are existing facilities being expanded. The company will also be adding a 1-mtpa EAF (electric arc furnace) in Kadapa, Andhra Pradesh, which will use scrap metal as a

raw material. These additions, which are at various stages of progress on the ground, will increase the installed capacity to 54.8 mtpa (10 per cent CAGR) by FY30. The company has announced a capex programme of ₹1.26 lakh crore with an annual run rate of ₹22,000-24,000 crore per year.

Beyond FY30, JSW Steel’s expansion is expected to reach 63.5 mtpa on its own and 16 mtpa through two JVs by FY32. The first JV is with Japan’s JFE Steel which will expand the existing 4.5-mtpa BPSL capacity by 10 mtpa through joint investment. The company has also entered into a JV with South Korea’s POSCO Steel to develop a 6-mtpa facility in Odisha, by FY32.

Although in stages and staggered, JSW Steel capacity and production should grow at 9-10 per cent CAGR in FY26-32. The company intends to develop a raw material supply chain for 50 per cent of the higher capacity targets for both iron ore and coking coal. The company has 13 of

the 25 iron ore mines operational and the rest will come online to support this. The company has acquired coal mines in Mozambique and increased its stake to 30 per cent in an Australian mine as well.

DEBT AND FINANCIALS

The company’s net debt has improved from ₹76,500 crore in March 2025 (3.34 times Net debt to EBITDA) to ₹53,800 crore in March 2026 (1.8 times). This was achieved, as after the BPSL resolution, the company transferred the asset to a 50:50 JV with JFE Steel on cash basis at an equity valuation of ₹31,500 crore. The cash flow to JSW Steel, which owned the equity and debt on the asset, allowed for the deleveraging. Final tranche of ₹7,900 crore is also expected, which will further decrease the leverage.

In FY26, the company reported consolidated revenue/EBITDA of ₹1,82,000 crore/26,388 crore (9 per cent/28 per cent growth. With sales of 29.64 mtpa (12 per cent growth), this translates to an EBITDA per tonne of ₹8,900. Assuming the EBITDA per tonne holds or marginally improves as stated earlier, and capacity expands, the company should generate ₹40,000 crore or more of EBITDA per year.

Based on cash flow outlook, the company has also revised down the maximum leverage ratio it intends to follow to 3 times from (3.75 times earlier) and a comfortable range of below 2.5 times

JSW Steel outlook on Indian steel consumption growth is now backed by a strong expansion plan to double its capacity. The JV with JFE and POSCO, which are the world’s leading steel producers, derisks the development to an extent and allows for exchange of technology to develop a value-added portfolio as well.

Steel consumption is tied to GDP growth of the country. The current uncertainty will be an overhang on growth till comprehensively resolved. JSW Steel capacity expansion is aimed at a longer horizon and so should the investor focus be.

Valuation support amid Summer blues

FMCG. Seasonal dependence persists for Emami, making volume revival and margin delivery key monitorables

Kumar Shankar Roy
bl. research bureau

When bl.portfolio recommended investors accumulate shares of FMCG major Emami in April 2025 at around ₹615, the investment case rested on its rural-led domestic franchise, strengthening non-seasonal portfolio, distribution expansion, margin resilience and valuation comfort relative to peers. That thesis has not played out as expected. Since then, the stock has declined around 35 per cent to about ₹399 (near 52-week lows), as FY26 earnings exposed continuing weather dependence, weak volumes in the fourth quarter and pressure on operating margins.

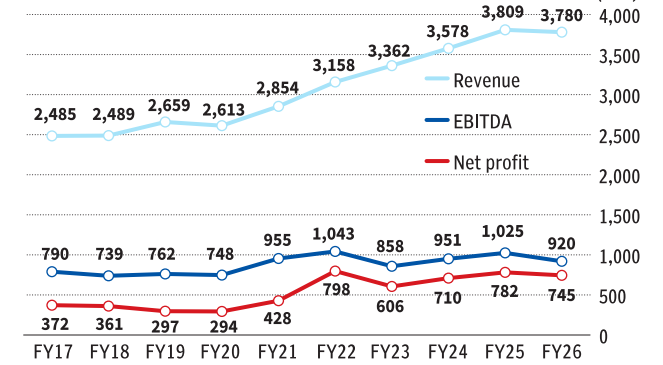
After a weak FY23, the company performed well in the next two years. But FY26 revenue inched 0.8 per cent down, while adjusted EBITDA fell 10 per cent and adjusted net profit declined 5 per cent. The weakness was more pronounced in Q4. Domestic volumes fell 7 per cent, sharper than the 3 per cent decline in domestic sales, indicating price and mix partly cushioned a weaker off-take.

Still, the correction in the Emami stock, improving traction in some hitherto underperforming categories, growth in newer businesses, consistent ₹700-800 crore annual free cash flow generation (4-4.5 per cent of m-cap), improved working capital and a net cash-positive balance sheet make the risk-reward quite reasonable. At a time when the broader market is still overvalued, Emami is relatively attractive. But given the global and local uncertainties, investors with a four-five-year time-frame with a stomach to absorb drawdowns can accumulate the stock at current levels.

Emami trades at 22.6 times trailing 12-month earnings, 20.5 times one-year forward earnings and 18.6 times two-year forward earnings, according to Bloomberg. Valuation comfort comes from the fact that the FY27-based Price to Earnings is



How financials stack up



Source: Bloomberg Figures are adjusted, rounded off and on consolidated basis

about 25 per cent below its five-year average. Estimated adjusted EPS growth (14 per cent in FY27, 11 per cent in FY28) over the next two years supports the medium-term upside potential.

BUSINESS PROFILE

Emami operates in the personal care and healthcare space. Founded in 1974, it has a portfolio of over 550 products.

The company’s domestic business accounts for about 82 per cent of revenues. This includes Navratna & Dermicool, Pain Management, BoroPlus, Healthcare, Kesh King, Male Grooming (Smart And Handsome), 7 Oils in One, and D2C brands The Man Company (men’s grooming and lifestyle) & Brillare (personal care label specialises in vegan, zero-dilution skincare and hair products). Emami does not provide detailed segment-wise disclosures. Overseas business accounted for 18 per cent of Emami FY26 sales.

The Emami business has historically carried meaningful seasonal exposure through cooling oils, talcum powders and related

Summer products. Emami has attempted to diversify away from this by investing in all-weather categories, new launches, digital-first brands and alternative sales channels.

However, FY26 demonstrated that seasonal categories still matter substantially to the overall outcome. The Navratna and Dermicool range declined 15 per cent during FY26 and 21 per cent in Q4. Talcum powder revenue alone declined about ₹100 crore during the year, with the category falling about 40 per cent in Q4. The company attributed this to delayed summer, inconsistent temperatures, unseasonal rainfall and a high base.

International business, too, was not immune to disruption. It grew 3 per cent during FY26, but declined 5 per cent in Q4 after growing 16 per cent during January and February. The March weakness was attributed to West Asia disruptions.

WHAT HAS IMPROVED

The encouraging part of FY26 is that the weakness was not broad-based. The ex-Summer domestic portfolio grew 11 per

● **ACCUMULATE** Emami ₹399.05

WHY

- Attractive after steep stock correction
- Ex-Summer portfolio and newer brands gaining traction
- Strong cash generation and net-cash balance sheet

cent in value and 7 per cent in volume during Q4. This suggests parts of the core business retained momentum.

A particularly relevant improvement is visible in hair care. Kesh King brand, which was one of the underperforming categories flagged in our earlier call, grew 14 per cent in Q4 FY26 after the company implemented its revival strategy. The Q4 recovery offers an early indication of improvement. The 7 Oils in One range also grew 34 per cent in Q4 and 13 per cent for FY26.

Other established categories showed healthier performance. Pain Management grew 11 per cent in Q4 and 7 per cent during FY26, while healthcare grew 7 per cent in Q4 and 5 per cent for the year. These businesses are important because they strengthen the non-summer part of the portfolio.

Newer brands have also begun contributing to growth. The Man Company and Brillare grew 34 per cent in Q4 and 20 per cent during FY26. The company’s strategic investment portfolio (new-age, D2C brands) grew 34 per cent in Q4, while the management expects these businesses to sustain 30 per cent annual growth. Brillare is expected to increase its absolute EBITDA by around ₹15 crore in FY27. These expectations still require delivery.

Axiom Ayurveda gives Emami an entry into the beverages category through its aloe vera-based fruit drink offering. The management views the product

as differentiated from standard cola beverages and disclosed that Axiom currently generates EBITDA of around ₹40-45 crore. IncNut, which houses Vedix and SkinKraft, gives Emami exposure to personalised beauty products. As per the management, the business has high gross margins with modest EBITDA losses. Emami also remains net cash positive (₹720 crore). This balance-sheet position provides flexibility to acquire and invest in brands.

WHAT NEEDS IMPROVING

The biggest concern is that overall growth remains vulnerable to summer categories. While the ex-Summer portfolio did well in Q4, it could not offset the decline in Navratna and Dermicool. The management expects Summer brands to grow at double-digits in the first half of FY27, but actual performance in the coming quarters is key.

The volume game also needs watching. Domestic volume decline of 7 per cent in Q4 was materially worse than the value decline. For an FMCG company with good rural exposure, consistent volume recovery is key.

Performance in some legacy brands remains soft. The BoroPlus range declined 8 per cent in Q4 and grew only 2 per cent in FY26. Male grooming fell 4 per cent in Q4 and 5 per cent during the year. These categories need to recover because faster-growing new businesses are still relatively small.

Profitability is another monitorable. Emami’s Q4 gross margin expanded 250 basis points, indicating benefits from pricing & cost management. However, these gains did not flow through to reported EBITDA, which fell 15 per cent. Ad & promotional spending rose to 22.9 per cent of revenue in Q4, up 330 basis points year on year, while full-year A&P stood at 19.6 per cent of revenue (vs 18.2 per cent in FY25). Investments behind newer brands are key to build scale, but whether they can grow without keeping company margins under stress, is to be seen.

businessline’s editorial policy prohibits analysts from taking positions in the stocks they recommend — Editor

Sensex ups & downs

	Price ₹		Movement	% change
	May 22	May 29		
Tata Motors PV	363.4	393.3	▲	8.2
Tech Mahindra	1,421.8	1,483.2	▲	4.3
L&T	3,926.9	4,076.7	▲	3.8
Eternal	242.0	250.9	▲	3.7
HCL Tech	1,163.8	1,184.4	▲	1.8
SBI	949.1	964.0	▲	1.6
Asian Paints	2,639.0	2,672.1	▲	1.3
Bajaj Finserv	1,765.3	1,784.7	▲	1.1
Adani Ports & SEZ	1,786.5	1,804.8	▲	1.0
Maruti Suzuki	12,987.5	13,119.9	▲	1.0
Axis Bank	1,285.3	1,287.9	▲	0.2
Kotak Mahindra Bank	384.2	384.7	▲	0.1
Tata Steel	209.2	208.9	▼	-0.1
Titan	4,081.0	4,074.7	▼	-0.2
NTPC	388.5	386.8	▼	-0.4
ICICI Bank	1,264.9	1,256.0	▼	-0.7
Ultratech Cement	11,574.9	11,449.3	▼	-1.1
Infosys	1,174.4	1,159.8	▼	-1.2
Bajaj Finance	916.4	904.7	▼	-1.3
Bharat Electronics	416.6	410.9	▼	-1.4
Trent	4,295.8	4,230.6	▼	-1.5
M&M	3,082.2	3,034.8	▼	-1.5
Power Grid	294.4	289.8	▼	-1.6
Bharti Airtel	1,871.4	1,829.7	▼	-2.2
Sun Pharma	1,845.2	1,800.9	▼	-2.4
Reliance Industries	1,354.6	1,320.6	▼	-2.5
HUL	2,202.0	2,146.0	▼	-2.5
TCS	2,317.3	2,253.9	▼	-2.7
HDFC Bank	766.4	744.8	▼	-2.8
ITC	301.8	287.0	▼	-4.9

How sectoral indices moved

	May 22	May 29	Movement	% change
POWER	8,081.8	8,383.1	▲	3.7
CAPITAL GOODS	78,316.9	80,818.7	▲	3.2
AUTO	57,290.4	57,983.4	▲	1.2
REALTY	6,044.7	6,115.2	▲	1.2
METALS	43,350.4	43,765.8	▲	1.0
BANKEX	60,904.5	61,131.3	▲	0.4
IT	28,065.4	28,165.1	▲	0.4
PSU	20,972.6	20,937.6	▼	-0.2
CONSUMER DURABLES	57,857.8	57,686.0	▼	-0.3
TECK	14,976.7	14,930.3	▼	-0.3
HEALTHCARE	47,267.5	46,806.4	▼	-1.0
OIL&GAS	27,123.9	26,741.0	▼	-1.4
FMCG	18,551.0	18,264.7	▼	-1.5

How other indices moved

NIFTY NEXT 50	69,783.1	71,073.7	▲	1.8
BANK NIFTY	54,055.4	54,239.2	▲	0.3
NIFTY 500	22,651.3	22,657.0	▲	0.0
NIFTY 200	13,675.9	13,663.7	▼	-0.1
NIFTY 100	24,669.3	24,608.5	▼	-0.2

WHO AM I?

Are you an avid investor? How well do you know corporate India?

Here’s a challenge. Using the five clues below, identify the company that is being talked about here

- 1 While I have carried my current corporate identity only since 2001, my business has nearly 90 years of credentials.
- 2 My CMD studied at Harvard, while his son, the fourth generation of the family associated with me, graduated from Yale.
- 3 While I continue to be the largest player in my industry in India, I am still a small-cap stock.
- 4 My industry has been in a downcycle; hence, all the top five players posted single-digit return on equity last year.
- 5 I have delivered about 20 per cent CAGR to shareholders over the last five and 10 years, despite being in a commodity business that is currently in a downcycle.

Send your answers by Wednesday 6 p.m. to who-am-i@thehindu.co.in, with your full name, postal address and phone number. A lucky winner in each week will get a book sponsored by UNIFI Capital as a reward.

Contributed by
UNIFI CAPITAL

Last week’s stock:
Five-Star Business Finance
Last week’s winner:
Gajanana Upadya

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50 (23,548) lost 0.7 per cent over the past week, whereas Nifty Bank (54,239) managed to gain 0.3 per cent. While broader derivatives positioning shows some moderation in bearishness, institutional investors continue to maintain a cautious stance.

Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) remain net short on index futures, although the net short position declined 11 per cent over the last week to 2.01 lakh contracts. However, they increased net short positions on index call options by 67 per cent to 2.71 lakh contracts and raised net long positions in index puts by 17 per cent to 4.62 lakh contracts, indicating that institutional traders retain bearish inclination. On the other hand, combined FII-retail positioning shows some improvement.

Net short positions on index futures reduced from 63,328 contracts to 47,877 contracts and net short call options declined sharply from 2.36 lakh contracts to 1.26 lakh contracts. Additionally, net put shorts increased from 2.43 lakh contracts to 3.24 lakh contracts, suggesting that bearish conviction has softened.

That said, cumulative futures Open Interest (OI) declined during the rollover week, falling from 237 lakh contracts to 200 lakh contracts in Nifty and from 31.1 lakh contracts to 27.5 lakh contracts in Nifty Bank. Coupled with the fact that both indices continue to face key resistance levels, the derivatives data points to a market where a decisive bullish breakout is still awaited.

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (Jun) opened with a gap-up last week and climbed to a high of 24,160 on Monday, triggering the stop-loss of 24,150 on



F&O TRACKER. Bearish conviction softens across derivatives, although charts continue to show resistance at higher levels

our recommended short position. While it attempted to stabilise above the key price band of 23,950-24,000 in the following sessions, the bears dragged the contract sharply lower, leading to a weekly loss of 0.2 per cent.

As the June futures fell and its OI more than doubled over the last week to 187 lakh contracts, the contract seems to have experienced short build-up. The Put Call Ratio (PCR) of June options, despite moderating from the previous week, stood at 1.17 on Friday, indicating that put open interest continued to exceed call open interest.

While this does not necessarily mean an imminent breakout of 24,000, the bears' degree of dominance has softened and they need to stay more cautious.

Since the resistance at 24,000 holds, there is a good chance for Nifty futures (Jun) to see a decline, possibly to 23,500, a support. A breakdown below this can strengthen the bears, potentially opening the door for a deeper decline to 23,000.

If the contract recovers, breaks out of 24,000 and sustains above it, we are likely to see a rally to 24,500. Resistance above 24,500 is at 24,800.

- TERMS APPLIED**
- FII bearish stance persists
 - Nifty Bank shows relative strength
 - Rollover sees lower participation

Strategy: Traders can consider initiating shorts if Nifty futures (Jun) rises to 23,925. Target and stop-loss can be 23,500 and 24,200, respectively.

Option traders can buy June expiry 23,500-put (₹299.45) if its premium declines to ₹240. Place stop-loss at ₹140 and book profits at ₹400.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (Jun), on Monday, opened with a gap-up and climbed to a high of 55,805, triggering the stop-loss of 55,400 on our recommended short position.

However, the contract drifted lower in the subsequent sessions. Unlike Nifty futures, Nifty Bank futures managed to wrap up the week just above the support at 54,600. For the week, it gained 0.6 per cent.

The rise was accompanied by an 80 per cent increase in open interest to 26.3 lakh contracts. While the Put Call Ratio (PCR) of June options remained at 0.94, indicating a mild bearish bias, the contract's ability to hold above 54,600 and the addition of fresh long positions point to improving sentiment in Nifty Bank.

That said, Nifty Bank futures must decisively break above 55,800 to establish a sustainable rally. Such a breakout can lift the contract to 56,750 and subsequently to 57,500.

If the contract slips below the support at 54,600, it could resume the downswing towards 53,150, a key support. A breakdown below this can strengthen the bearish case and potentially drag the contract to 51,800.

Strategy: Short Nifty Bank futures (Jun) if it breaches the support at 54,600. Place stop-loss at 55,300. Book profits at 53,200.

Option traders can buy June expiry 52,500-put if Nifty Bank futures breaks down below 54,600. The option can be bought at the prevailing premium and held so long as the futures contract trades below 55,300. Book profits when Nifty Bank futures approaches 53,200.

Will ATM strike do?

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. ATM strike is one just above the current price of the underlying price

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

NSE offers several strikes on each of the underlying on which options are traded. The strike interval rule is based on the guidelines given by SEBI. We have frequently discussed in this column that the at-the-money (ATM) option on an underlying should be the most optimal choice for a long position.

Why do traders prefer other strikes? This week, we explore the reasons why in-the-money (ITM) and out-of-the-money (OTM) strikes are also traded.

STRIKE PREFERENCES

Suppose all option traders go long on the ATM strike. Even in such a scenario, you will have multiple strikes available on any trading day on the NSE. Why? If the Nifty Index trades at 23,790, the 23,800 call will be the ATM strike.

Note that the ATM strike is one just above the current price of the underlying price. This definition fits with the Black-Scholes-Merton model that defines an ATM option as the strike which is equal to the forward price of the underlying at



- DIFFERENCE**
- The immediate ITM strikes carry lower time value than the ATM strike, translating into lower time decay or theta

expiry. Now, suppose you initiate a long position on this strike. You will initiate the position only if you believe that the Nifty Index is likely to climb up.

Suppose the Nifty Index moves to, say, 23,930. Two observations are worth noting. One, the 23,800 strike will be now in-the-money (ITM), with 130 points of intrinsic value. And two, traders who want to buy the

ATM strike with the Nifty Index at 23,930 will have to buy the 23,950 strike. So, even in a world where all traders buy only ATM strikes, NSE will have to introduce newer strikes to meet the demand as the underlying moves up.

But traders do not always trade the ATM strike, even though this strike is sympathetic to option Greeks; previously in this column, we showed that the ATM strike is the most sensitive to change in time (highest theta), change in volatility (highest vega) and change in delta (highest gamma). Why are ITM and OTM strikes traded when traders are aware that the ATM strike is rich in Greeks? The im-

mediate ITM strikes carry lower time value than the ATM strike. That translates into lower time decay or theta.

So, some traders may prefer these strikes. Note that the flip side is that these strikes lose more because of the decline in option delta when the underlying falls. What about OTM strikes? Many novice traders prefer such strikes because the absolute premium is low. Unfortunately, these strikes do not offer optimal reward-risk potential.

OPTIONAL READING

You should not be overwhelmed by the choice of strikes available on the NSE. Whether you want to go long or short, the ATM option is typically optimal because of the Greek sensitivities.

But as the underlying climbs up and the ATM strike becomes ITM, the strike will gradually give up its intensity relating to the Greeks. It is a similar argument when the underlying moves in the opposite direction and the ATM strike becomes OTM.

(The author offers training programs for individuals to manage their personal investments)

Bounce on the cards

BULLION CUES. Supports can aid the bulls

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,540/ounce) was up 0.7 per cent last week, whereas silver (\$75.3/ounce) slipped 0.3 per cent. Gold futures (Aug) (₹1,60,911/10 gm) dropped 0.3 per cent and silver futures (Jul) (₹2,66,998/kg) lost 1.8 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,60,911)

Gold futures (Aug), ever since hitting a high of ₹1,68,101 on May 13, has been declining. But towards the end of last week, it saw a recovery on the back of the 21-day moving average at ₹1,59,700. Also, there is another support at ₹1,57,500.

Gold futures is likely to recover to ₹1,66,000 in the near term. If the support at ₹1,57,500 is breached, the contract can extend the decline to ₹1,52,000.

Trade strategy: Traders can buy gold futures (Aug) at ₹1,59,500. Place stop-loss at ₹1,54,800. Revise this up to ₹1,61,000 when the contract touches ₹1,63,000. Book profits at ₹1,66,000.

MCX-SILVER (₹2,66,998)

Silver futures (Jul) has been os-



cillating between ₹2,65,000 and ₹2,78,000 over the past couple of weeks, barring a brief drop to ₹2,61,000 on May 28.

Notable support levels are at ₹2,61,000 and ₹2,54,600. At ₹2,54,600, the 50-day moving average and a trendline coincides, making it a good base.

We can expect silver futures to recover, either from the current level or after declining to ₹2,54,600. Once the rally begins, the contract can go up to ₹2,85,000. A breach of ₹2,54,600 can turn the outlook bearish, which can trigger a fall to ₹2,38,000.

Trade strategy: Buy silver futures if the price dips to ₹2,61,000. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹2,52,000. When the contract rises to ₹2,78,000, trail the stop-loss to ₹2,69,000. Book profits at ₹2,85,000.

Breakdown watch

CRUDE CHECK. Support comes under pressure

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices tumbled over the last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$91.10/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹8,281/barrel) slumped 12 per cent and 9.7 per cent, respectively.

BRENT FUTURES (\$91.10)

Brent crude oil futures closed below a crucial support at \$94 last week. While this indicates that the bulls have lost strength, there is one more support ahead at \$88, which the buyers will resort to.

In case there is a recovery, Brent crude futures can rise to \$97. A breakout can lift to \$102-103 price band. But given the prevailing price action, a rally past \$97 is unlikely.

A breach of \$88 can trigger another leg of downswing, dragging the price to \$80-82 support band.

MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹8,281)

Crude oil futures (Jun) slipped below the 50-day moving average support last week. The chart shows that the contract has formed a double-top pattern by



witnessing a rejection twice at ₹10,000 in the last month. The neckline is at ₹8,200.

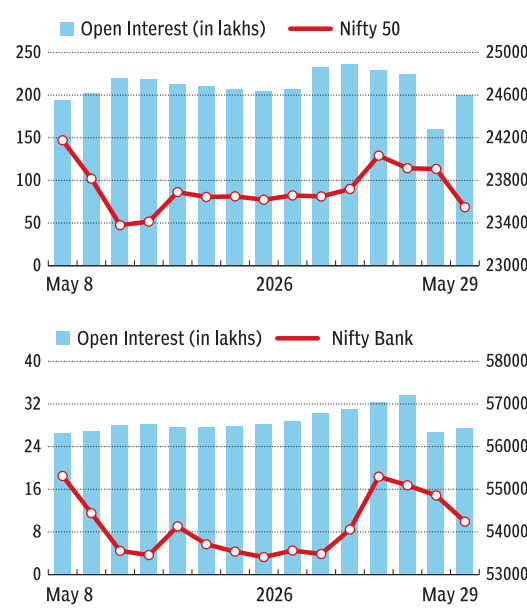
A breach of ₹8,200 will confirm the pattern, leading to a price decline to ₹6,400, per this chart set up. But there are support levels at ₹7,600 and ₹7,000, which can, at the least, trigger a corrective rally.

Only a rally beyond ₹9,160 will lead to a sustainable recovery from the current level. Overall, there is a bearish bias.

Trade strategy: We had suggested a long position at ₹9,200 with stop-loss at ₹8,200. Hold this for now and we suggest the below action if the stop-loss is hit.

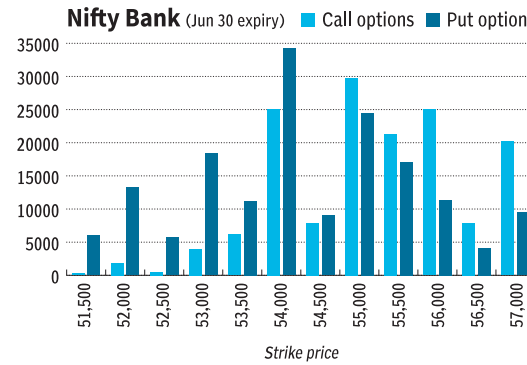
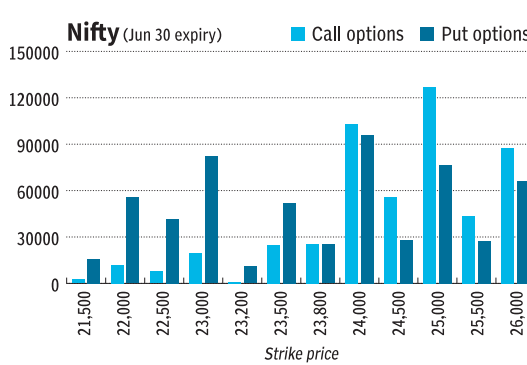
Go short if the crude oil futures breaches the support at ₹8,200. Target and stop-loss can be ₹7,000 and ₹8,800, respectively.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

(as on May 29)
Put-Call ratio Nifty **1.17** | Nifty Bank **0.94**



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on May 29	Weekly change %	As on May 29	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	31724	-27	242451	-5
Future Index Short	233033	-13	89019	-4
Net Futures	-201309	-11	153432	-5
Index Call options Long	553247	-15	3203100	21
Index Call options Short	823871	1	3057999	12
Net Call options	-270624	67	145101	-297
Index Put options Long	842769	-9	1884923	-23
Index Put options Short	381083	-28	2670685	-13
Net Put Options	461686	17	-785762	23

FII's have reduced net short on index futures. However, they've increased net short on index calls and net long on index puts, which are bearish signals.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on May 29)				
BDL	1,204.60	-8.2	157.3	61.7
LICI	411.50	1.2	465.2	54.2
COALINDIA	457.90	0.3	1551.3	25.9
CONCOR	463.65	-8.4	405.4	18.8
ALKEM	5,498.00	1.7	21.7	11.0
FALL (as on May 29)				
LUPIN	2,267.70	-0.6	100.4	-52.2
NUVAMA	1,554.60	5.0	22.9	-51.9
KFINTTECH	857.75	4.9	71.7	-48.0
POLYCAB	9,477.50	2.3	30.3	-47.5
BLUESTARCO	1,589.00	-4.1	40.9	-45.5

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Jun 1)

Nil

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
(Weekly change %)				
COMMODITIES (as on May 29)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Jun	386.0 (0.6)	3,985 (33)	Long build-up
COPPER	30-Jun	1,331.5 (-2.3)	663 (-94)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOIL	18-Jun	8,281.0 (-9.7)	12,393 (-17)	Long unwinding
CRUDEOILM	18-Jun	8,281.0 (-9.7)	34,497 (11)	Short build-up
GOLD	5-Aug	1,60,911.0 (-0.3)	7,764 (86)	Short build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Jun	1,27,280.0 (-1.0)	12,898 (44)	Short build-up
GOLDM	3-Jul	1,58,354.0 (-0.9)	36,477 (83)	Short build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Jun	15,954.0 (-0.9)	1,74,114 (23)	Short build-up
GOLDTEN	30-Jun	1,58,581.0 (-0.9)	27,226 (61)	Short build-up
LEAD	30-Jun	207.0 (0.5)	363 (27)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	25-Jun	316.0 (8.6)	19,517 (30)	Long build-up
SILVER	3-Jul	2,66,998.0 (-1.8)	10,115 (7)	Short build-up
SILVERM	30-Jun	2,71,574.0 (-1.6)	22,677 (9)	Short build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Jun	2,71,618.0 (-1.6)	58,890 (13)	Short build-up
ZINC	30-Jun	365.1 (-0.6)	2,439 (55)	Short build-up
CURRENCIES (as on May 29)				
USDINR	25-Jun	95.27 (-0.8)	1729933 (171)	Short build-up
EURINR	25-Jun	111.19 (-)	14455 (-)	-
GBPINR	25-Jun	128.06 (-0.5)	33520 (17090)	Short build-up
JPYINR	25-Jun	60.02 (-)	79 (-)	-

F&O Strategy

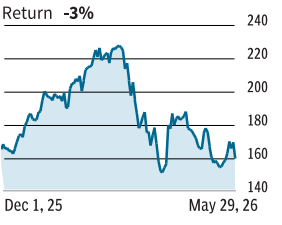
Sell Ashok Leyland futures

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Ashok Leyland (₹155.44) is ruling at a crucial level. It finds an immediate support at ₹148 followed by another one at ₹134. A close below the latter will change the medium-term outlook negative.

Immediate resistance levels are at ₹167 and ₹186. A close above the latter will re-confirm bullish trend. However, we expect the stock to see downward bias.

F&O pointers: Ashok Leyland June futures closed



at ₹154.81 against the spot close of ₹155.44. The contract saw strong accumulation of open interests. The futures trading at a discount signals the existence of short positions.

Strategy: Traders can short Ashok Leyland futures while keeping a stop loss at ₹155.50. This is strictly for traders who have higher risk tolerance given the higher margin obligation for futures and one-to-one price movement of futures, meaning higher risk when compared to options if the stock moves in the opposite direction.

Traders can aim for an initial target of ₹149. Traders with higher risk appetite can even aim for ₹144. On Monday, if the stock opens higher (above ₹158) or lower (below ₹150), traders can stay away from this strategy.

Follow up: HPCL might not have provided an entry point. However, traders who initiated the position can continue to hold and the same can be reviewed next week.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading.

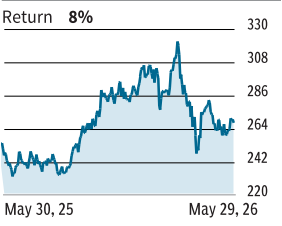
Short Take

Bank of Baroda F&O adjustments

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

On May 12, Bank of Baroda (₹268.50) announced an interim dividend of ₹8.5. The face value per equity share is ₹2. The dividend will lead to necessary adjustments in the futures and options (F&O) contracts on this stock on the record date.

The company has decided June 5 as the record/effective date. On this day, the stock price and all derivatives contracts on Bank of Baroda will be adjusted appropriately.



With respect to adjustment in futures contracts, the reference rate of the relevant contract on June 4 will be considered. Reference rate will be the mark-to-market settlement price of the relevant futures contract. So, the open positions shall be carried forward to June 5 at the daily settlement price on June 4 minus ₹8.5, the dividend amount.

Suppose the June expiry futures closes at ₹270 on June 4, it will be revised to ₹261.5 (₹270 minus ₹8.5). Hence, the contract value will come down.

Likewise, in options, all the strike prices in the options chain of Bank of Baroda will be subtracted by ₹8.5 from June 5. For example, the strike price of 270 and 280 will be modified to 261.5 and 271.5, respectively.

That said, the above measures are not likely to impact the overall trend of this stock. So, traders can stick to their views and are only required to note the changes in the contracts that they hold.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index opened the week on a positive note with a wide gap-up on Monday. However, they failed to get a strong follow-through rise after that. Sensex and Nifty fell sharply on Friday giving away all the gains. The indices closed the week lower by 0.8 and 0.7 per cent, respectively. Nifty Bank index also witnessed a strong sell-off on Friday. However, it managed to close the week marginally higher by 0.3 per cent. The Sensex, Nifty 50 and the Nifty Bank indices look vulnerable to fall more from here. To avoid the fall, the indices have to bounce back immediately and breach their near-term resistance decisively.

FPIS SELL
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continue to sell Indian equities. However, the quantum of selling has come down in the last two weeks. The equity segment saw a net outflow of about \$268 million last week. The FPIs have sold about \$3.45 billion in the month of May. There has been a net outflow of about \$22.64 billion in the last three months.

NIFTY 50 (23,547.75)
Short-term view: Failure to get a strong follow-through rise and a sharp fall on Friday has turned the short-term picture weak. Nifty looks vulnerable for a fall to 23,000. A break below 23,000 can drag the index further down to 22,400 in the coming weeks. A fall beyond 22,400 is less likely. We can expect the index to reverse higher from around 22,400 again.

Key resistances are at 23,700, 23,850 and 23,900. Nifty has to breach these hurdles and then get a sustained rise above 24,000. Only then the chances of a rise to 24,300 and 24,700 will come back into the picture.

Medium-term view: The broader 22,000-26,500 range remains intact for now. Earlier, we had expected the index to move up within this range. But now, it looks like Nifty can fall back again towards the lower end of the range.

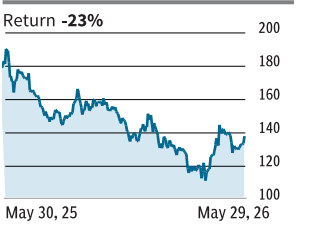
However, the big picture remains positive. We retain our bullish view of seeing a break above 26,500 eventually. Such a break can take the Nifty higher to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

A fall below 22,000 is needed to turn the outlook bearish.

MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU, bl. research bureau

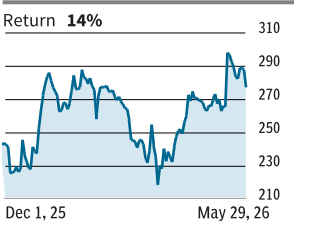
IREDA (₹134.15)
Making a U-turn



The stock of IREDA (Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency) has been in a downtrend since July 2024. However, since early last month, it has started showing signs of a bullish trend reversal. The chart shows formation of a higher base and the price has crossed above 21- and 50-day moving averages.

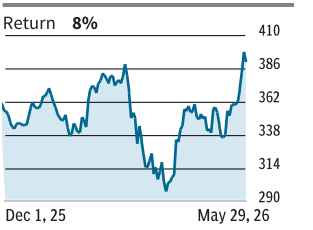
Also, the stock appreciated for two weeks in a row. In the coming weeks, we expect the scrip to surpass the nearest hurdle at ₹142 and see an upward move to ₹160. So, buy now at ₹134 and ₹125. Place stop-loss at ₹110 at first. When the stock touches ₹145 and ₹155, tighten the stop-loss to ₹135 and ₹150, respectively. Exit at ₹160.

Nazara Technologies (₹278.55)
Forms a double-bottom pattern



Since August last year, the stock of Nazara Technologies has been witnessing higher volatility. While the price saw movements in both directions, the price action over the past few months hints at a potential shift in trend, particularly after the stock broke out of ₹290 three weeks back. This breakout has confirmed a double-bottom pattern, denoting a bullish trend reversal. We anticipate the stock to surpass the prior high of ₹362.50 and touch ₹400. So, participants can buy the stock now at ₹278 and accumulate at ₹260. Keep initial stop-loss at ₹210. When the price touches ₹330 and ₹370, alter the stop-loss to ₹300 and ₹345, respectively. Exit at ₹400.

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles (₹393.25)
Strong recovery

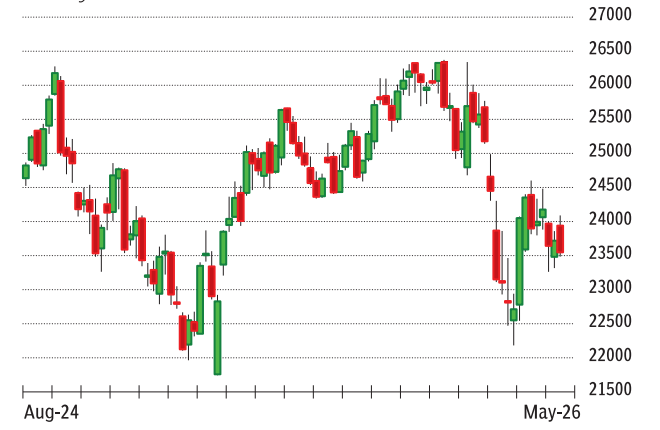


However, the stock can resume the rally and rise to ₹500 in the near term. Therefore, traders can go long on TMPV now at ₹393 and buy more shares at ₹340. Place stop-loss at ₹320. When the price rises to ₹430, move the stop-loss higher to ₹395. Tighten the stop-loss further to ₹440 when the stock goes up to ₹470. Liquidate the longs at ₹500.

Hang in there!

INDEX OUTLOOK. Nifty 50, Sensex and Nifty Bank index look vulnerable to fall more

Nifty 50: Knocked down



That looks less likely in the absence of any new and strong negative trigger.

NIFTY BANK (54,239.20)

Short-term view: Nifty Bank index broke the resistance at 55,100 initially last week but did not sustain.

Immediate support is at 53,700 which can be tested in the near term. A bounce from this support and a subsequent rise above 54,500 can be bullish for a rise to 56,000-56,500.

But if the index breaks below 53,700, it can come under more selling pressure. In that case, a fall to 51,000-50,500 can be seen.

Medium-term view: The broader bullish view will remain intact as long as the index stays above 50,000. Intermediate resistances are at 58,500 and 60,500. A decisive rise above 60,500 can boost the momentum for a rise to 64,000-65,000 in the medium term. That in turn will keep the doors open for a rally to 68,000-69,000 in the long term.

The bullish view will get negated only if the Nifty Bank index declines below 50,000. But that looks less likely as seen from the charts.

SENSEX (74,775.74)
Short-term view: The rise to

SUPPORTS TO WATCH OUT FOR

- Nifty 50: 23,000, 22,400
- Sensex: 74,100, 73,000
- Nifty Bank: 53,700, 50,500

76,500 happened last week but did not sustain. Sensex touched a high of 76,627 and then fell sharply giving back all the gains. The index can test 74,100 initially this week. A break below it can drag it down to 73,000 in the short term.

The region between 76,500 and 77,100 is a crucial resistance zone. Sensex has to rise past 77,100 to get some breather. Only then the chances of a rise to 78,000 and higher will come back into the picture.

Medium-term view: The index is now coming down within its broad 71,000-86,000 range. In case the fall extends beyond 73,000, the downside can be limited to 71,000.

We retain our positive bias to see a bullish breakout above 86,000 eventually. That will then take the Sensex higher to 90,000 initially. It will also have the potential to target 94,000 over the long term.

This bullish view will go

wrong only if the Sensex declines below 71,000. If that happens, a fall to 69,000 can be seen.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (22,571.40)

The index has come down sharply after making a high of 23,007 last week. Immediate support is at 22,400. A break below it can drag the Nifty Midcap 150 index down to 21,900-21,800 in the short term.

The broader picture continues to remain positive. Crucial resistance is at 23,100. We expect the index to breach this hurdle in the coming weeks. Such a break can take the Nifty Midcap 150 index to 26,000-26,500 initially. It will also keep the doors open for the index to target 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The region between 21,800 and 21,600 is a good short-term support. Lower supports are at 21,300 and 20,800. The index has to decline below 20,800 to turn the outlook bearish and negate the above-mentioned bullish view.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (16,992.10)

The rise above 16,900 keeps the broader bullish view intact. Immediate support is in the 16,900-16,800 region. The short-term picture will turn negative for a fall to 16,600-16,500 only if the index declines below 16,800.

If the index manages to sustain above 16,800, there are good chances to see a rise to 17,500 in the coming week. That will also keep intact our view of testing 18,000 in the short term.

The region around 18,300 is a crucial resistance. We expect the index to surpass this hurdle going forward. That, in turn, will boost the momentum and take Nifty Smallcap 250 index higher to 22,500-23,000 and even 24,000 in the long term.

The index has to decline below 14,000 to negate his bullish view, which looks unlikely at the moment.

bl.portfolio
video

Watch **bl. Guru** share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English

Tamil

No going back

US MARKET OUTLOOK. NASDAQ coming close to a key resistance

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index continue to move up. The US benchmark indices are retaining their strength and are keeping intact their broader uptrend. The Dow Jones and the S&P 500 have more room to rise from current levels. The NASDAQ Composite index, on the other hand, is coming close to a crucial resistance. The price action in the next couple of weeks is going to be very crucial to see if the NASDAQ Composite index is going to reverse the trend or not.

DOW JONES (51,037.09)

The rise to 51,300-51,500 mentioned last week is happening in line with our expectation. From a medium-term perspective, the Dow Jones has potential to target 52,000-52,500 on the upside.

Immediate support is at 50,800, below which 50,300 and 50,000 are the next important supports. The short-term outlook will turn negative only if the index declines below 50,000. In that case, 49,300-49,000 can be seen on the downside.

From a big picture, the region around 52,500 is a strong resistance which can halt the current rally. So, we have to turn cautious as the index approaches 52,500.

S&P 500 (7,580.05)

The break above 7,500 has happened in line with our expectation. That boosts the bullish momentum and keeps the door open for more rise. The level of 7,500 can now act as a good near-term support.

The S&P 500 index can rise to 7,700-7,750 from here. A corrective fall to 7,600-7,550 thereafter cannot be ruled out.

From a big picture, the S&P 500 has the potential to target



GETTY IMAGES

CRUCIAL JUNCTURE

The NASDAQ Composite index is coming close to a strong resistance which can halt the current rally

7,800-7,850. We can expect the current rally to find a top anywhere in this 7,800-7,850 region and then reverse lower.

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (26,972.62)

The rise and break above 26,800 have happened as expected. That keeps intact our bullish view of seeing 27,500 on the upside.

The region around 27,500 is a strong trendline resistance. As such there are good chances for the current rally to halt around 27,500.

A downward reversal from around 27,500 and a subsequent fall below 26,900 can trigger a corrective fall. That leg of fall can drag the NASDAQ Composite index down to 26,000 and even lower.

As such, we suggest everyone to remain cautious now rather than being overly bullish.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (98.94) remained broadly stable all through the week. The immedi-

ate outlook is mixed. Near-term support is at 98.70. A break below it can take the index down to 98.55-98.50. A further break below 98.50 will increase the downside pressure and drag the dollar index down to 97.80.

On the other hand, good resistance is in the 99.45-99.55 region. The index has to breach 99.55 decisively to gain some strength. In that case, the bullish case will strengthen for a rise to 100.50-101 going forward.

We will have to wait and watch.

TREASURY YIELD

Crude oil price tumbling below \$100 per barrel has dragged the yield sharply lower last week. The US 10 Year Treasury Yield (4.44 per cent) fell breaking below the support at 4.5 per cent. This was contrary to our expectation. We had expected the yield to bounce back from this support.

There is support near current levels. So, an immediate bounce from here can give some relief and take the 10 year treasury yield higher to 4.6 per cent again. But failure to rise above 4.48 per cent from here can continue to keep the yield under pressure. In that scenario, the yield can fall to 4.35 per cent first.

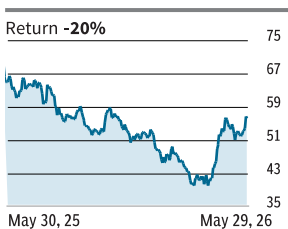
A further break below 4.35 per cent can drag it down to 4.25 per cent as well.

TECH QUERY



GURUMURTHY K, bl.research bureau

I bought Suzlon Energy at ₹67 a couple of years ago. What is the technical outlook?
Joseph P D, Angamaly, Kerala



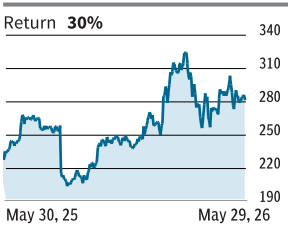
Suzlon Energy (₹57): The bounce from the low around ₹38 made in March is significant. This is happening from the 200-Week Moving Average support, currently at ₹41.

Also, price action

over the last one month leaves the bias positive to breach the immediate resistance at ₹59. This will take Suzlon Energy share price to ₹100. You can buy more at current levels. Keep a stop-loss at ₹46. Move the stop-loss to ₹58 when the price goes up to ₹72. Revise it to ₹73 and ₹88 when the share price touches ₹85 and ₹94, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹100.

I have bought Karur Vysya Bank (KVB) at ₹225. Should I continue to hold, or sell?

D V S Kumar

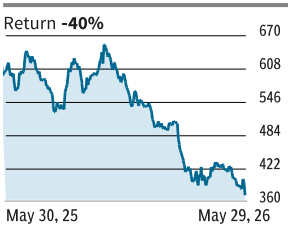


KVB (₹289): The trend is up and strong. Support is in the ₹275-₹255 region. The stock can oscillate between ₹255 and ₹325 for a few months. The bias is positive to breach

₹325 and rise to ₹400. The bullish view will go wrong if the price declines below ₹255. In that case, ₹220 can be seen. You can consider two options. One, keep a stop-loss at ₹245 and hold the stock. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹310, ₹355 and ₹375 when the price goes up to ₹345, ₹370 and ₹390, respectively. Exit the stock at ₹400. Second option is, exit 25 per cent of your holding at current levels. Keep a stop-loss at ₹245 for the rest and follow the same strategy mentioned above.

I have shares of Cello World. I am in loss now. Can I continue to hold?

C S Singh

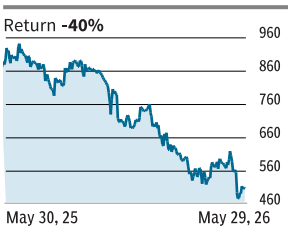


Cello World (₹369): Since you have not mentioned your purchase price, it is difficult to give a precise advise. The trend is down since July 2024. The fall below ₹540 in

January marks the resumption of the broader downtrend. Resistances are at ₹410 and ₹440. Higher resistance is in the ₹520-₹540 region. As long as the stock stays below these, there is danger of the price tumbling towards ₹240-₹230. A rise above ₹540 is needed to indicate a bullish reversal. But that looks unlikely. It's better to exit and accept the loss.

I bought KEC International shares at ₹586. What is the outlook?

U C Prabhu



KEC International (₹500): The stock peaked at ₹1,312 in December 2024 and has been in a strong downtrend. Significant resistances are in the broad ₹620-₹710 region. Any

intermediate bounce is likely to be capped at this resistance zone. Ideally, the stock has to rise past ₹710 to become bullish. But that looks unlikely now and it will also need some strong positive trigger. There is room on the downside to see ₹310-₹300 from here. Exit the stock with minimum loss now. It will become a very good buy around ₹310-₹300. You can re-enter this stock after the fall happens. There is potential for the stock to go back up to ₹700-₹800 from around ₹310-₹300.

Please send your questions to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week	Last week's prize winner G Radha Krishnan
1 Ola Electric Mobility	Last week's winning stock Sammaan Capital
2 ACME Solar Holdings	Closing price (May 22) ₹161.65
3 Metropolis Healthcare	Closing price (May 29) ₹177.10
4 Allied Blenders & Distillers	Return: 9.56 per cent
5 Premier Energies	

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to **bandublockbuster@gmail.com** with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.



Scan to know the winner selection process

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.8 and 0.7 per cent respectively last week. BSE Power gained the most by 3.7 per cent, followed by BSE Capital Goods 3.2 per cent and BSE Auto 1.2 per cent. BSE FMCG and BSE Oil & Gas declined by 1.5 and 1.4 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Realty	Tech
P/E	20.3	20.1	33.4	13.8	56.8	65.6	33.3	41.3	19.9	19.8	8.3	38.2	11.2	37.2	20.3
P/BV	3.2	4.0	6.4	2.2	15.9	15.8	7.6	7.1	5.8	3.4	1.6	5.3	2.3	4.9	7.5
Dividend Yield	1.4	1.2	1.3	1.0	0.4	0.5	0.9	0.5	3.1	0.9	2.8	1.0	2.4	0.4	2.4
Weekly Return (%)	-0.7 ▼	-0.8 ▼	1.2 ▲	0.4 ▲	3.2 ▲	-0.3 ▼	-1.5 ▼	-1.0 ▼	0.4 ▲	1.0 ▲	-1.4 ▼	3.7 ▲	-0.2 ▼	1.2 ▲	-0.3 ▼
Monthly Return (%)	-2.6 ▼	-3.5 ▼	0.7 ▲	-1.9 ▼	3.7 ▲	-3.4 ▼	-4.4 ▼	4.9 ▲	-0.3 ▼	1.5 ▲	-4.2 ▼	2.5 ▲	-5.6 ▼	-1.6 ▼	-0.3 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-5.2 ▼	-8.4 ▼	9.8 ▲	-3.0 ▼	14.4 ▲	-1.5 ▼	-10.5 ▼	9.6 ▲	-24.5 ▼	39.9 ▲	-2.1 ▼	22.8 ▲	6.2 ▲	-17.5 ▼	-17.4 ▼
The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.															

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr:High	Yr:Low
360 ONE [1]	1107.2	29.9	37.0	4.6	202603	35.9	15.7	29.9	12.9	-0.5	14.3	2.0	1273.0	906.2
3M India [1]	32760.5	542.7	60.4	17.2	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-1.4	39.8	0.0	38300.0	28300.0
A B B [2]	7229.6	71.9	100.6	19.6	202603	5.8	-25.2	14.8	-3.3	8.1	9.8	0.1	7825.0	4640.5
AB Lifestyle [2]	100.2	1.7	58.6	8.7	202603	11.9	57.7	7.2	29.4	-1.9	11.7	2.3	176.1	87.7
AB Real Estate [2]	131.1	20.7	35.4	7.8	202603	15.7	11.4	23.9	18.4	-1.1	7.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1
Adarh Htg. Fin. [2]	476.9	25.4	18.8	2.9	202603	18.2	27.0	18.2	21.5	0.3	11.4	2.8	547.8	424.2
Adani Industries [5]	474.6	11.4	41.8	2.9	202603	13.1	42.7	14.1	25.2	-0.4	6.2	0.7	522.9	338.2
AAVAS Financiers [2]	1349.5	61.9	21.8	2.8	202603	12.4	22.3	25.4	14.2	-3.5	9.9	3.2	2152.0	1050.3
AMC India [2]	260.0	24.0	10.8	1.2	202603	20.5	9.7	-3.4	10.6	0.0	0.0	0.0	8992.0	3654.0
ACC [2]	1358.9	112.4	12.4	1.3	202603	16.9	-62.9	17.3	-9.0	-2.9	17.9	0.0	2127.8	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	310.6	8.3	37.4	5.7	202603	12.5	0.9	44.0	87.6	7.2	7.4	2.8	324.3	195.7
Action Const. Eq. [2]	885.9	34.9	25.4	5.3	202603	7.1	-6.5	-1.4	1.4	0.5	40.2	0.0	1276.0	746.1
Adani Energy Sol [2]	1513.2	19.0	79.6	7.2	202603	18.6	23.5	21.6	30.0	10.6	10.1	2.2	2578.0	783.0
Adani Ent. [2]	293.7	16.7	17.5	4.7	202603	20.3	-124.0	-0.6	48.1	0.2	10.6	0.0	302.5	175.5
Adani Green [2]	1475.1	11.2	131.5	12.2	202603	9.1	40.7	11.6	8.5	8.3	9.4	6.4	1532.0	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1804.8	56.3	32.0	4.3	202603	26.5	11.4	27.1	14.9	1.0	14.0	0.9	1843.1	1291.0
Adani Power [2]	245.5	6.7	36.6	7.2	202603	-0.1	52.3	-3.5	-0.8	-11.0	21.2	0.7	254.2	105.7
Adani Total Gas. [1]	72.6	0.6	129.6	17.5	202603	16.1	8.9	17.9	0.2	18.3	17.4	0.4	85.7	453.5
Aditya AMC [2]	1056.6	33.8	31.3	7.6	202603	6.9	-18.0	9.5	5.0	4.5	35.5	0.0	1122.8	708.0
Aditya B. Far. [2]	64.6	-6.1	1.4	202603	15.7	-184.0	11.2	-4.9	-4.3	0.0	1.3	95.0	1.5	53.6
Aditya Birla Cap. [2]	363.6	14.5	25.1	2.8	202603	10.2	29.4	12.1	15.1	1.8	9.5	4.4	375.9	218.5
Aegis Logistics [1]	749.5	25.6	29.3	4.3	202603	52.2	45.7	23.2	35.4	3.5	14.5	0.9	943.9	576.0
Aegis Vopak Term [2]	196.2	2.3	86.1	4.6	202603	22.2	17.6	25.8	75.0	-5.8	7.0	2.5	320.0	158.8
Aether Industri. [2]	1096.6	17.0	64.3	5.9	202603	27.0	4.8	38.3	35.3	4.2	9.7	0.7	1274.2	723.2
Affcons Infrastr. [2]	339.3	6.5	40.0	2.3	202603	-18.9	-179.7	-4.8	-36.0	13.1	14.4	0.6	744.1	265.9
Affle B [2]	146.8	3.2	45.4	12.7	202603	20.3	16.0	19.5	35.1	2.5	26.6	1.1	2186.1	1251.5
AIA Engineering [2]	4496.8	136.4	33.0	5.2	202603	9.6	37.9	0.1	19.9	12.4	19.1	0.1	4551.0	300.0
Ajanta Pharma [2]	291.0	84.5	34.4	8.0	202603	21.5	18.4	17.3	14.7	-6.7	-32.0	0.0	331.4	233.5
Alcembich Pharma [2]	735.1	37.0	19.9	2.6	202603	4.4	40.8	10.1	26.9	-2.7	13.1	0.2	1107.8	635.3
Alkem Lab [2]	155.4	6.4	24.4	6.4	202603	10.0	15.0	15.9	20.9	-1.7	14.9	4.3	2173.0	118.9
Alkyl Amines [2]	1653.5	35.2	47.0	5.5	202603	0.2	-1.4	-2.3	-3.3	-3.8	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4
Allied Blenders [2]	560.9	8.2	68.1	9.4	202603	9.4	-48.1	11.4	18.2	4.5	21.0	0.9	720.0	382.7
Alok Industries [1]	12.8	-1.6	-0.3	202603	3.1	-214.3	0.2	14.9	3.8	0.0	0.0	23.5	1.1	0.0
Alpena Infra Ener. [1]	886.6	38.5	23.0	1.2	202603	15.5	11.6	15.9	39.1	1.0	15.6	0.0	109.5	61.5
Amber Enterp. [2]	7616.3	57.1	133.4	6.1	202603	10.5	-26.8	22.2	17.3	3.5	13.5	0.8	8970.0	540.4
Amulja Cements [2]	448.0	20.0	22.4	1.9	202603	9.4	108.2	15.4	15.5	2.7	12.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Anand Rath. Wea. [5]	3450.5	47.7	72.4	28.7	202603	29.7	40.5	22.3	32.1	-0.5	16.8	0.1	3983.4	1858.7
Antares Pharma [2]	154.7	2.7	56.9	1.2	202603	15.2	16.7	11.9	11.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	183.5	40.0
Angel One [1]	337.3	10.0	33.6	5.0	202603	38.2	83.5	19.9	-21.9	-0.6	14.8	0.5	351.0	208.9
Apur Inds. [2]	13092.3	249.1	52.6	9.8	202603	26.6	3.7	23.3	21.6	2.5	32.6	0.1	13590.0	6800.0
APL Apollo Tubes [2]	1832.4	43.3	42.3	9.6	202603	34.1	20.9	9.7	58.9	-2.6	22.0	0.2	2300.9	1493.0
AR Capital [2]	8176.0	385.4	21.1	12.4	202603	15.2	35.0	19.5	35.3	-2.2	17.5	0.6	942.0	351.5
Apollo Tyres [1]	394.5	33.6	11.7	1.7	202603	14.2	254.7	0.0	72.5	-0.1	10.9	0.3	540.3	365.4
Aptus Value Hou. [2]	259.6	18.8	13.8	2.6	202603	18.7	26.0	25.2	25.5	-0.2	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5
Asahi Inds. Cap [1]	903.8	13.9	65.2	5.9	202603	15.5	43.2	7.8	1.7	5.7	9.9	0.9	1073.0	689.9
Ashtoka Labs [2]	155.5	6.4	24.4	6.4	202603	10.0	15.0	15.9	20.9	-1.7	14.9	4.3	2173.0	118.9
Ashtoka Plastics [1]	2672.1	46.3	57.7	12.0	202603	10.8	43.6	5.1	13.2	1.3	11.4	2.8	2985.5	216.0
Aster DM Health. [2]	728.1	7.8	93.6	8.9	202603	18.2	39.2	12.2	17.6	-3.7	11.6	0.5	776.2	519.8
Astral [1]	1585.7	20.6	77.0	10.5	202603	24.2	21.2	12.6	5.6	2.9	20.8	0.1	1768.0	1262.8
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	7873.5	76.6	113.2	24.8	202603	20.4	-26.6	32.6	0.6	0.8	32.9	0.0	10653.1	7630.0
Aurum Energy [1]	661.7	11.4	60.3	2.8	202603	15.2	15.2	15.2	15.2	-0.1	0.0	0.0	2050.0	427.5
Atul [2]	883.0	230.3	29.7	3.2	202603	15.0	66.1	12.4	40.1	-2.7	12.8	0.7	779.0	5563.0
AU Small Finance [2]	987.1	35.3	28.0	3.7	202603	17.5	65.2	16.0	25.4	0.9	0.0	107.9	682.5	
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	1430.9	61.1	23.4	2.2	202603	4.4	2.0	6.4	-1.8	-2.3	14.2	0.2	1050.0	701.0
Autum Invest [1]	476.9	22.7	21.0	2.8	202603	-78.6	96.6	-42.0	54.5	-6.6	29.7	0.1	883.5	400.0
Avenue Super. [2]	4062.0	45.5	89.2	10.8	202603	18.9	19.2	15.9	9.7	-1.4	18.0	0.0	4196.3	352.7
AWL Agri Busine. [1]	192.5	8.2	23.6	2.4	202603	17.7	53.5	17.3	13.4	-1.3	19.8	0.3	285.4	171.2



GETTY IMAGES

When the rubber hits the road

MOMENT OF TRUTH. Plugging loopholes in a health insurance cover is as important as getting one

K Bharat Kumar

Health insurance is an umbrella that promises to protect you when it rains. Unfortunately, only after it starts pouring will you notice the leaks – some minor, some humongous. Hence it always pays to be prepared for the leaks, just in case.

I had a personal experience when a family member was faced with a serious illness. Along the way I discovered some must-haves and good-to-haves. Here are a few:

FINE PRINT ALWAYS SURPRISES

First, the fine print always surprises you. At some point, we will have to accept that there is no way we will be fully aware of all the nuances of a health policy. In our family's case, we realised only when we made a claim that any treatment involving immunotherapy or monoclonal therapy would be eligible for no more than a minuscule portion of your sum insured, as per norms. The fine print did mention this in the policy document but then, rarely do we read all of the fine print. And, would we have refused a policy even if we had noticed this condition? Unlikely. After all, when we are healthy, we feel serious illnesses only affect 'others', never ourselves.

The suggestion here would be

to take a policy specific to a particular illness. Our reaction to a family member's suggestion made two years earlier, that we take out separate policies to protect against cancer or cardiac risk, was to ask ourselves how many such policies could we take, especially if the existing generic policy covers all illnesses? With the benefit of hindsight, I would still go for a policy specific to cancer treatment and/or cardiac treatment, in addition to a generic health insurance policy. We have all seen how common cardiac issues have become.

A breast oncology specialist in the family practising in the UK says that as a thumb rule, cancer used to occur in one in five people earlier and that she wouldn't be surprised if that becomes one in two in the near future! This strengthens the case for considering a cancer cover, if premiums are affordable.

The other thing about fine print is that there are workarounds. For example, I did not know that my policy allowed me only 3 per cent of sum insured as daily maximum room rent. At ₹2 lakh sum insured, the policy did not fully cover the room rent of about ₹10,000 at a popular city hospital.

PROPORTIONAL COVERAGE – A CURVE BALL While we were prepared to shell

COVER GAPS

- Consider separate cancer and cardiac covers, if affordable
- Room-rent caps can shrink all related claim payouts
- A reliable agent can fight delayed claim denials

out the remaining for the room rent for an 80-odd day stay in hospital across four admissions in a six-month period, where we were impacted most was that the policy only allowed proportional coverage for other charges such as doctor fees, investigation and treatment charges. This means that if the policy covered only 60 per cent of the room rent, it would cover only 60 per cent of all other charges. With all the exclusions (such as caregiver's meals, disposables used in investigation or treatment, etc), the settlement at any point in time came to only 50 per cent of our total expenses. That too, because we had two insurance policies, one via my employer and one personal policy.

Only when the personal policy came up for renewal the subsequent year, did I become aware that an extra premium would allow for de-

linking the other charges from the room rent coverage and give you full coverage against those charges. So, it would be worth checking if your current policy has a clause similar to proportional coverage, in which case it would be worth signing up for that extra premium that delinks room rent and other charges.

GOOD AGENT IS CRITICAL

It always helps to have a knowledgeable insurance agent who looks to your interest. When I bought a car a few years ago, I emphatically refused the insurance offer from a highly perseverant dealer as I did not wish to move away from my insurance agent, a senior citizen, who had been handling both my motor and family health insurance policies for a decade prior.

At the time, I could not have imagined that a couple of years later the same agent would help me get a couple lakh rupees that was rightfully due to me from the insurance firm, but was unfairly denied due to an error on their side. At a time when I was personally too tired to fight, the agent took it upon himself as explained below.

CALLOUSNESS

Now, with any serious illness of a loved one comes emotional and financial trauma. Be prepared to add to these the trauma of having to deal with callous insurance professionals if you are unlucky. They do not intend to

make life difficult for you, but it's not clear why many a time there is such a lackadaisical approach to claims.

For expenses for our first stay in hospital of about 25 days, we spent mostly out of pocket because of some confusion regarding two policies being submitted for one patient. We applied for reimbursement for the full amount after we exited the hospital in January 2024. There was no response despite repeated requests until May. Meanwhile, necessity for more in-patient treatment arose and those claims were partly approved for cashless claims via the hospital on the day of discharge after each round of treatment.

When we escalated our original reimbursement claim with the senior management of the insurance firm, the third-party administrator rejected the claim. When asked for the reason, we were told that the reimbursement would have been possible for the base policy but now, after several rounds of treatment, the base policy had been exhausted and the top-up policy could not be used for reimbursement claims.

At that point, the entire family was at the end of our tether. We did not have the energy or inclination to fight for the ₹2 lakh or so due to us. This is when our insurance agent took the matter into his hands, behaved like a family elder, dragged me to the insurance office and presented his argument strongly – had the company settled the original January 2024 reimbursement claim in time, it would well have fallen under the base policy. The remaining rounds of treatment would have then been covered under the top-up policy instead of getting adjusted under the base policy. If the insurance company delayed response, leave alone the decision, from January to May of that year, why should the claimant be penalised for no fault of theirs? Post a strong and well presented argument from the agent, the insurance company ended up reimbursing whatever was left of the sum assured at the time.

This neither struck me nor would I have taken this up without my agent's insistence. But the insurance company ought to have acted on empathetic lines without being reminded.

After all this trauma, you might wonder if it is worth opting for health insurance. My answer would still be an emphatic 'Yes'. In this instance, two insurance policies helped cover about one-third of the total amount spent in medical treatment. When the total sum is large, 33 per cent respite is a great deal. The deal can be better than this if you plan well for the possible leaks in the policy you have signed up for.

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.85	6.4	6.4	May 06
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Apr 23
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.7	6.25	May 18
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	6.65	6.5	6.25	6	May 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	May 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	5	6.45	6.1	6	Apr 01
Union Bank	5.9	6.6	6.2	6	Apr 20
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	May 29
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7.35	6.5	5.75	Apr 06
City Union Bank	6.25	7.25	6.5	6.25	May 29
DCB Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.25	May 02
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	7	6.5	7.25	May 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	May 29
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.25	7.25	7.15	Apr 18
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.75	6.15	6.15	Apr 11
Kotak Bank	6	6.8	6.8	6.4	May 14
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	7.2	6.55	6.55	Apr 06
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.6	6.8	6.2	May 14
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.5	7.25	7	6.7	Apr 10
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	7.75	7.75	6	May 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	8.11	7.5	7.77	May 19
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	8.1	7.5	7.25	May 05
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

Data as on respective banks' website on 29 May 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com;

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

Small Savings Scheme		Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
		Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit		4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)		6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme		8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme		7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate		7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund		7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra		7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana		8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
*Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, Govt of India

SIMPLYPUT.

Retirement Income Scheme

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

Two friends, Nirmal and Rahul, are chatting over tea.

Nirmal: Rahul, I read that the pension fund regulator PFRDA has launched a Retirement Income Scheme (RIS) under NPS. What's new about it?

Rahul: Until now, NPS (National Pension System) was mainly about building a retirement corpus. Once you retire, a part of that corpus had to be used to buy an annuity (a product that provides regular pension income) and the rest could be withdrawn as a lump sum.

The new Retirement Income Scheme addresses a different question: how can retirees convert the portion of their NPS corpus that is not used to purchase an annuity into a steady income stream without withdrawing it all at once? Under the scheme, retirees can keep this balance invested within the NPS and draw it down gradually through monthly, quarterly, or annual payouts until the age of 85.

Nirmal: How is this different from the existing annuity option?

Rahul: The annuity requirement remains unchanged. Government employees must still use at least 40 per cent of their corpus to buy an annuity, while non-government subscribers must annuitise at least 20 per cent. RIS applies only to the remaining corpus. Instead of taking the balance as a lump sum and figuring out where to

invest it, you can keep it within NPS and withdraw it systematically over time.

Nirmal: Where is this money invested while I'm drawing income from it?

Rahul: It is invested in a new fund called RIS Steady. It follows a glide-path strategy. At age 60, the fund allocates 35 per cent to equities/shares, 10 per cent to corporate bonds and 55 per cent to government securities. As you age, the equity exposure is gradually reduced and the allocation to safer assets increases.

The idea is simple. Retirement can easily last 20 to 30 years. A retiree still needs some equity exposure to beat inflation, but risk should reduce with age. RIS Steady tries to strike that balance automatically.

Nirmal: How do the withdrawals work?

Rahul: There are two methods. One is Systematic Payout Rate (SPR). Here, the annual withdrawal rate depends on your age. At age 60, the payout rate works out to about 4 per cent. So if your drawdown corpus (the amount kept aside for phased withdrawals) is ₹1 crore, you would receive roughly ₹4 lakh a year, or around ₹33,000 a month. The amount remains fixed for one year and is recalculated annually. SPR rate increases with age.

The second method is Systematic Unit Redemption (SUR). When you opt for it, your corpus is converted into units and a fixed number of units is redeemed every payout



GETTY IMAGES

period. It is like the SWP (Systematic Withdrawal Plan) of mutual funds. For example, a ₹1-crore corpus with an NAV (net asset value) of ₹10 translates into 10 lakh units. If these are spread over 25 years of monthly payouts, about 3,333 units are redeemed every month. Since the fund's NAV changes, the rupee amount you

receive can vary.

Nirmal: What are the advantages of this new RIS scheme?

Rahul: The biggest benefit is that it tackles longevity risk, i.e. the risk of outliving your savings. Many retirees struggle to manage a large lump-sum corpus after retirement.

Another advantage is that

SPR discourages excessively high withdrawal rates. That reduces the risk of depleting the corpus too quickly, especially during the initial periods of poor market returns.

Nirmal: Is there a catch?

Rahul: Yes. Unlike an annuity, RIS does not guarantee income. The corpus remains invested in market-linked assets, so returns and payouts can fluctuate. Also, the preset asset allocation may not suit everyone. Some retirees may find the 35 per cent equity exposure too aggressive, while others may consider it too conservative.

Retirees shouldn't assume RIS is the perfect answer for everyone. Each person's financial situation is different. The right choice will depend on income needs, risk appetite, tax considerations and how comfortably the payouts can sustain their lifestyle through retirement.



UNIGOLD FINANCE[®]
GOLD LOAN

UNIGOLD FINANCE LIMITED

Regd. Office: 802C1, Pinnacle Corporate Park, Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai, Maharashtra, India, 400051.
CIN- U64990MH1995PLC456809 Contact - +91245 97879
Email: compliances@unigoldfinance.com, Website : www.unigoldfinance.com

AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE QUARTER AND YEAR ENDED MARCH 31, 2026

In compliance with Regulation 52 of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Listing Obligations and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015 ("Listing Regulations"), the Board of Directors of Unigold Finance Limited ("**Company**") at their meeting held on Friday, 29th May, 2026 approved the Audited Financial Results (Standalone) for the Quarter and Year Ended 31st March, 2026 ("**Results**"). The Results, along with the Auditor's Report (Standalone) issued by M/s. Vekam & Associates, Statutory Auditor of the Company are available on the website of the Company at www.unigoldfinance.com and on the website of the Stock Exchange i.e. BSE Limited at www.bseindia.com In compliance with Regulation 52 (8) of the Listing Regulations, we hereby notify that the same can also be accessed by scanning the following Quick Response (QR) code:

For Unigold Finance Limited
Sd/-

Place : Mumbai
Date : 29th May 2026





bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	59.2	16542	1.4	0.5	-4.9	10.7	10.0	13.2	0.32
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	105.5	75650	1.7	1.2	-3.1	13.8	13.3	13.7	0.46
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	87.7	51690	3.5	2.8	-1.8	14.1	15.3	14.4	0.52
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1081.0	38121	1.5	1.0	-3.8	11.1	12.0	12.7	0.40
*****	JM Large Cap	147.6	422	2.8	1.3	-1.6	12.1	11.3	10.7	0.34
*****	Kotak Large Cap	547.0	10599	1.7	0.7	-3.0	11.3	10.7	12.1	0.34
*****	SBI Large Cap	91.2	53468	1.5	0.8	-0.2	10.8	11.1	11.9	0.37
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	500.2	28970	1.4	0.8	-3.8	11.3	11.1	11.8	0.35
***	Bandhan Large Cap	75.0	2007	1.8	0.8	-0.4	13.1	11.5	12.4	0.36
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	215.8	2579	1.7	0.7	-1.4	13.1	11.8	12.4	0.38
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	80.5	1439	2.1	0.7	-3.0	10.9	10.9	12.3	0.34
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	974.1	7236	1.5	1.0	-2.8	10.9	8.6	10.4	0.28
***	Invesco India Largecap	68.0	1722	1.8	0.7	-0.3	14.2	12.3	12.4	0.38
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	107.7	38239	1.3	0.5	-3.0	9.6	9.5	12.5	0.29
***	Tata Large Cap	494.4	2688	1.7	0.8	-0.4	11.9	11.2	11.7	0.36
***	UTI Large Cap	255.8	12053	1.9	1.2	-5.5	8.8	8.6	11.2	0.26
***	DSP Large Cap	447.0	7192	1.5	0.7	-5.5	13.1	10.9	11.2	0.36
***	HSBC Large Cap	454.6	1784	2.1	1.2	-1.6	10.9	10.0	11.7	0.30
**	LIC MF Large Cap	51.4	1352	3.6	2.4	-7.7	7.8	7.7	10.0	0.22
**	Union Largecap	22.6	439	2.1	1.3	-2.7	9.5	9.5	-	0.29
**	Axis Large Cap	56.9	30498	1.6	0.7	-4.6	8.8	7.0	11.4	0.18
*	Groww Largecap	41.7	128	2.7	1.4	-0.7	11.0	10.1	10.8	0.29
*	PGIM India Large Cap	320.8	544	2.5	0.9	-4.1	7.5	7.3	9.8	0.21
-	Mahi Manu Large Cap	21.4	701	2.0	0.6	-6.3	9.9	9.0	-	0.28
-	Taurus Large Cap	152.7	51	2.1	1.9	-1.0	12.1	10.3	9.9	0.31
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	137.9	16672	1.4	0.4	5.7	21.8	17.7	15.9	0.57
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	332.8	28255	1.6	0.8	0.2	16.7	16.2	14.6	0.51
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	995.8	29757	2.0	1.2	0.3	17.9	17.8	15.6	0.63
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	33.2	15582	2.0	0.9	4.4	15.7	14.0	-	0.39
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	123.3	3249	2.0	0.7	6.7	19.1	16.4	16.0	0.44
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	631.4	38426	1.7	1.0	5.0	15.3	14.8	14.9	0.51
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	179.3	5896	1.9	1.0	2.2	18.9	15.8	14.1	0.54
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	89.4	468	2.1	1.0	3.1	15.6	13.3	12.7	0.41
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	241.9	24675	1.4	0.5	-4.2	13.2	12.2	15.0	0.38
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	601.6	17331	1.4	0.5	-1.9	16.9	13.4	14.7	0.43
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	87.0	4531	1.9	0.5	2.6	15.9	14.0	14.5	0.44
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	100.4	9761	1.5	0.5	5.5	22.3	17.1	15.9	0.48
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	337.6	30251	1.6	0.6	1.5	15.6	14.5	15.1	0.45
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	150.7	42338	1.3	0.5	3.3	15.0	12.3	16.8	0.37
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1456.8	7081	1.8	1.1	1.5	18.0	15.7	13.2	0.49
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	182.6	3399	1.7	1.1	-1.6	13.7	11.5	11.3	0.36
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.2	2958	3.5	2.3	-3.4	15.8	12.3	14.3	0.39
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	85.1	6575	1.8	0.8	2.6	14.1	13.4	14.2	0.39
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	484.6	7802	1.5	0.6	-6.2	8.9	10.8	12.4	0.33
**	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	901.8	5648	1.6	0.9	1.6	13.1	9.5	11.7	0.24
*	Navi Large & Midcap	35.1	300	2.1	0.5	0.5	10.8	11.6	12.7	0.34
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	28.8	4877	3.1	2.0	11.6	19.9	15.9	-	0.39
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1939.1	100479	1.3	0.7	-0.7	17.5	17.4	15.9	0.63
*****	JM Flexicap	93.9	5041	2.6	1.4	-3.0	17.1	16.4	16.2	0.49
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	82.2	140950	1.1	0.5	-0.5	14.8	14.6	16.9	0.57
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	37.6	3320	1.9	0.5	1.4	15.4	13.7	14.6	0.42
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1549.1	19049	1.4	0.8	-4.7	14.6	13.6	13.0	0.43
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	35.1	5793	1.9	0.6	-0.5	9.8	9.3	13.5	0.27
*****	Union Flexi Cap	49.6	2294	1.7	0.8	-1.0	12.5	11.9	12.8	0.36
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1847.0	25632	1.4	0.7	4.8	16.4	12.9	14.1	0.39
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	203.2	7285	1.5	0.9	-0.7	13.4	11.4	10.9	0.36
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	328.3	13083	1.5	0.5	-1.4	12.0	11.1	13.9	0.35
***	DSP Flexi Cap	98.9	11769	1.5	0.6	-3.3	13.3	11.2	14.0	0.32
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	222.7	5405	2.3	1.5	0.4	17.8	14.5	13.1	0.40
***	Kotak Flexicap	83.3	54839	2.4	0.6	-0.3	13.7	12.0	13.5	0.37
***	SBI Flexicap	105.4	22403	2.3	1.5	-0.2	9.6	9.5	12.0	0.30
***	Tata Flexi Cap	23.3	3633	1.6	0.6	-2.4	13.0	10.7	-	0.34
**	Axis Flexi Cap	26.0	12546	1.7	0.6	-0.4	12.7	9.8	-	0.27
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	57.0	12770	1.9	1.1	-5.5	18.3	11.9	12.3	0.32
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.6	260	2.1	0.5	6.4	11.7	11.4	-	0.34
**	UTI Flexi Cap	295.6	22168	1.6	1.0	-7.1	7.3	5.9	11.2	0.14
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	97.2	973	3.5	2.4	4.1	11.6	10.3	10.1	0.29
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	19.2	128	3.3	1.7	-2.3	8.5	8.2	-	0.20
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	219.1	344	2.1	2.0	-1.8	12.2	10.4	9.7	0.31
-	Quant Flexi Cap	107.6	6594	2.0	0.8	10.9	19.3	17.4	19.7	0.47
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	286.8	3219	1.7	0.8	3.0	16.6	15.5	14.4	0.44
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	839.2	16997	1.7	0.9	6.6	19.7	16.6	15.3	0.56
-	Invesco India Multicap	122.3	3995	1.6	0.6	-5.6	14.3	12.2	13.3	0.35
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	36.7	6439	1.6	0.4	6.8	19.4	16.4	-	0.47
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	296.6	52634	1.6	0.9	0.7	18.4	19.9	15.8	0.64
-	Quant Multi Cap	642.0	7466	1.9	0.7	2.7	13.1	12.7	17.2	0.32
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	366.8	2807	2.0	0.9	-1.4	14.5	13.7	14.5	0.42
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	105.5	15911	1.8	0.6	7.6	23.9	20.0	18.7	0.57
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	199.9	94745	1.3	0.7	6.0	22.4	20.4	18.0	0.65
*****	Quant Mid Cap	219.7	7905	2.9	1.8	0.2	17.8	16.9	16.9	0.47
*****	Invesco India Midcap	183.2	11767	1.5	0.5	9.0	24.7	20.1	18.3	0.55
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	35.5	4688	1.6	0.4	9.5	23.7	19.1	-	0.54
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	92.2	35735	1.6	0.8	-8.0	18.5	22.1	16.4	0.58
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	4384.4	45820	1.5	0.8	8.4	23.9	21.3	18.8	0.63
***	Axis Midcap	116.2	32276	1.6	0.5	5.4	17.9	15.0	17.0	0.44
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	109.1	2389	1.7	0.5	10.0	21.1	17.2	15.9	0.51
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	337.5	7557	1.8	1.0	17.4	26.1	19.5	17.6	0.59
***	Kotak Midcap	139.1	63539	1.4	0.4	7.2	20.4	17.8	17.7	0.53
***	PGIM India Midcap	63.4	10738	2.0	0.8	1.2	12.3	12.8	15.6	0.38
***	SBI Midcap	234.6	23247	1.6	0.9	0.4	14.2	15.6	14.0	0.49
**	Sundaram Mid Cap	1442.1	13378	1.7	0.9	7.0	23.0	19.1	15.2	0.56
**	Tata Mid Cap	446.5	5604	1.6	0.6	7.6	19.3	16.7	16.3	0.50
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	805.1	6290	1.6	0.9	5.1	18.9	16.5	13.9	0.48
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2682.1	12102	1.5	0.9	-0.6	18.7	15.1	14.4	0.44
**	Taurus Mid Cap	116.8	123	2.1	1.7	-2.9	12.8	12.2	14.8	0.33
**	UTI Mid Cap	300.4	11680	2.1	1.3	1.9	15.2	14.1	14.1	0.40
*	DSP Midcap	149.1	19459	1.4	0.6	4.1	18.5	12.7	14.8	0.37
*	HSBC Midcap	446.0	13387	3.6	2.5	19.3	27.4	19.5	17.8	0.49
*	LIC MF Midcap	29.4	347	2.4	1.3	2.0	19.0	14.6	-	0.39
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	173.3	72673	1.4	0.7	4.8	19.7	20.9	20.9	0.56
*****	Quant Small Cap	267.6	30374	2.0	1.1	6.6	20.8	20.5	19.3	0.49
*****	AXIS Small Cap	106.7	27364	1.7	0.7	3.0	16.2	16.8	18.2	0.51

bl rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	51.2	2168	1.7	0.5	11.6	21.9	19.4	-	0.47
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	42.9	11038	1.5	0.4	7.0	22.9	20.0	-	0.53
***	DSP Small Cap	205.9	17906	1.4	0.6	7.0	19.4	18.4	16.6	0.48
***	HDFC Small Cap	132.6	38168	1.5	0.7	-1.8	14.5	16.9	17.4	0.48
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	85.9	8741	1.8	0.8	0.5	14.3	15.9	16.1	0.52
***	Kotak Small Cap	253.8	17416	1.7	0.6	-1.5	13.8	13.7	16.5	0.39
***	Sundaram Small Cap	276.2	3563	1.9	0.9	10.1	19.7	17.9	15.0	0.47
***	Tata Small Cap	35.5	11330	1.5	0.4	-8.8	11.7	15.2	-	0.42
***	Union Small Cap	54.0	1980	1.8	0.8	17.0	20.3	18.1	16.3	0.45
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	170.0	13850	1.5	0.8	-0.5	17.2	18.0	15.2	0.48
**	HSBC Small Cap	82.2	16394	1.8	0.7	3.0	16.8	18.6	18.5	0.46
**	SBI Small Cap	168.1	37141	1.6	0.9	-0.2	12.7	13.7	17.8	0.4

b1. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Month %	3 Month %	6 Month %	1 Year CAGR	
CASH FUNDS										
LIQUID FUNDS										
-	360 ONE Liquid	2118.8	1048	0.4	0.2	5.2	6.3	6.1	5.9	-
-	Aditya Birla SL Liquid	444.2	56604	0.3	0.2	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	Axis Liquid	3070.8	51643	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.7	6.4	6.2	-
-	Bandhan Liquid	3327.9	17385	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.6	6.2	6.1	-
-	Bank of India Liquid	3175.8	1735	0.1	0.1	5.7	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid	3167.9	11412	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	Canara Robeco Liquid	3318.7	6395	0.1	0.1	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
-	DSP Liquidity	3936.3	22480	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
-	Edelweiss Liquid	3527.2	15091	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.7	6.3	6.2	-
-	Groww Liquid	2666.2	278	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
-	HDFC Liquid	5408.2	72873	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	HSBC Liquid	2747.8	17559	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	ICICI Pru Liquid	407.9	54639	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	Invesco India Liquid	3789.1	16549	0.2	0.1	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	ITI Liquid	1433.8	55	0.2	0.2	5.5	6.3	6.0	6.0	-
-	JM Liquid	75.2	2835	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.4	6.1	6.0	-
-	Kotak Liquid	5569.7	42389	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	LIC MF Liquid	4983.0	15638	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	Mahi Manu Liquid	1793.6	1059	0.2	0.1	5.5	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	Mirae Asset Liquid	2889.0	13590	0.2	0.1	5.4	6.4	6.2	6.1	-
-	Motilal Oswal Liquid	14.5	974	0.4	0.2	5.0	5.9	5.8	5.7	-
-	Navil Liquid	29.8	76	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.7	5.6	5.7	-
-	Nippon Ind Liquid	6726.4	37903	0.3	0.2	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	Parag Parikh Liquid	1528.5	5260	0.2	0.1	5.7	6.5	6.2	6.1	-
-	PGIM India Liquid	359.0	584	0.2	0.1	5.9	6.7	6.3	6.2	4.30
-	Quant Liquid	43.4	1266	0.6	0.3	4.6	5.4	5.6	5.7	-
-	Quantum Liquid	36.8	529	0.3	0.2	5.1	5.7	5.7	5.6	-
-	SBI Liquid	4307.2	74571	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.3	6.1	-
-	Sundaram Liquid	2428.7	7086	0.4	0.1	5.5	6.5	6.1	6.0	-
-	Tata Liquid	4342.1	27400	0.3	0.2	5.8	6.5	6.3	6.1	-
-	Union Liquid	2653.2	8163	0.2	0.1	5.8	6.5	6.3	6.2	-
-	UTI Liquid	4523.3	31184	0.3	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.3	6.2	-
-	WhiteOak Capital Liquid	1481.0	568	0.3	0.2	5.3	6.4	6.1	6.0	-

OVERNIGHT FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Overnight	1456.0	6108	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Axis Overnight	1432.1	11376	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.2	5.4	-
-	Bandhan Overnight	1436.9	632	0.1	0.0	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Bank of India Overnight	1377.3	43	0.1	0.1	7.1	5.9	5.5	5.6	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Overnight	1419.8	867	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Canara Robeco Overnight	1400.2	296	0.7	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	DSP Overnight	1446.1	2116	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Edelweiss Overnight	1399.6	208	0.2	0.2	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Franklin Ind Overnight	1411.8	949	0.1	0.1	5.2	5.2	5.2	5.4	-
-	Groww Overnight	1389.9	83	0.3	0.2	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	HDFC Overnight	3983.4	9431	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	HSBC Overnight	1409.0	4223	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	ICICI Pru Overnight	1454.2	11369	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Invesco India Overnight	1367.1	337	0.1	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	ITI Overnight	1364.9	16	0.2	0.1	4.8	4.8	4.8	5.0	-
-	JM Overnight	1370.0	89	0.2	0.1	4.9	4.9	4.9	5.1	-
-	Kotak Overnight	1439.2	7487	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	LIC MF Overnight	1396.2	530	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Mahi Manu Overnight	1395.8	128	0.2	0.1	4.9	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Mirae Asset Overnight	1384.3	1389	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Nippon Ind Overnight	144.9	6199	0.2	0.2	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	PGIM India Overnight	1393.9	44	0.2	0.2	5.0	4.9	5.0	5.2	-
-	SBI Overnight	4355.8	27043	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.1	5.3	-
-	Sundaram Overnight	1432.2	624	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.0	5.0	5.2	-
-	Tata Overnight	1422.2	4376	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	Union Overnight	1419.6	411	0.2	0.1	5.1	5.1	5.1	5.3	-
-	UTI Overnight	3675.5	5730	0.2	0.1	5.0	5.1	5.1	5.3	-

b1. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	577.9	19985	0.5	0.3	5.9	7.0	7.1	6.3	10.83
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Ultra Short Dur	1625.6	651	0.4	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.7	6.2	-
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4240.6	11083	1.1	0.4	5.8	6.6	6.7	6.7	18.83
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	16.0	4458	0.4	0.2	5.8	6.7	6.9	6.0	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.2	15929	0.8	0.4	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.1	8.82
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1379.1	1420	0.4	0.2	6.0	6.9	7.1	6.2	1.41
*****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4451.7	4126	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.6	6.3	7.74

b1. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.5	5916	1.2	0.4	5.4	6.3	6.4	5.6	8.36
*****	DSP Ultra Short	3573.7	4167	0.9	0.3	5.4	6.4	6.5	5.6	7.24
*****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.9	16753	0.7	0.4	5.6	6.6	6.8	6.0	4.41
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1426.7	3118	0.4	0.2	5.9	6.8	6.9	6.0	-
*****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2836.6	1073	0.7	0.2	5.7	6.6	6.8	5.8	9.14
*****	Kotak Savings	45.0	16824	0.8	0.4	5.6	6.5	6.6	5.8	6.77
*****	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1448.1	212	0.6	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.8	5.9	3.55
*****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6286.4	12553	0.6	0.4	5.7	6.7	6.8	6.0	8.65
*****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1427.6	580	1.1	0.6	5.4	6.2	6.3	5.6	-
*****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3320.5	154	0.9	0.4	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.6	7.16
*****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1385.8	342	1.4	0.2	5.4	6.2	6.3	5.5	1.58
*****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.7	167	1.0	0.4	5.2	6.1	6.3	5.6	3.01
*****	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.9	5713	1.0	0.3	5.6	6.4	6.5	5.6	8.37
*****	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3987.0	498	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.3	6.3	5.4	-
*****	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.2	428	1.2	0.2	4.9	5.5	5.6	4.8	-
*****	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2802.8	1817	1.4	0.2	4.8	5.7	5.9	5.1	1.71

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Savings	572.8	27700	0.6	0.4	5.8	7.1	7.3	6.4	6.63
*****	UTI Low Duration	3733.3	3108	0.4	0.3	5.6	7.0	7.0	7.2	7.09
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3253.1	6084	0.7	0.4	5.6	6.9	7.0	6.1	7.38
*****	DSP Low Duration	20.8	5108	0.5	0.3	5.2	6.6	6.7	5.9	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	60.5	21926	1.1	0.5	5.2	6.6	6.8	5.9	12.68
*****	HSBC Low Duration	30.1	1058	0.9	0.4	5.4	7.4	7.3	6.2	9.66
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	686.4	13267	1.0	0.4	4.9	6.3	6.4	5.7	10.00
*****	Bandhan Low Duration	40.5	6121	0.6	0.3	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.8	-
*****	Canara Robeco Savings	44.3	1140	0.4	0.2	5.5	6.7	6.8	5.9	-
*****	Invesco India Low Duration	3971.3	1690	0.5	0.3	5.4	6.7	6.8	5.9	6.04
*****	JM Low Duration	38.9	223	0.9	0.4	5.3	6.6	6.7	5.8	5.59
*****	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3927.6	9417	1.0	0.4	5.3	6.7	6.7	5.9	7.52
*****	SBI Low Duration	3654.3	13458	0.9	0.4	5.0	6.4	6.6	5.7	3.92
*****	Tata Treasury Advantage	4127.5	2859	0.5	0.2	5.4	6.7	6.8	5.9	3.99
*****	Kotak Low Duration	3497.5	16259	1.2	0.4	5.0	6.5	6.6	5.7	11.10
*****	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1713.0	561	0.9	0.3	5.2	6.4	6.6	5.6	13.58
*****	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2366.0	2314	0.7	0.2	5.1	6.5	6.6	5.7	4.97
*****	Sundaram Low Duration	3613.6	369	1.1	0.4	4.8	6.3	6.4	5.6	3.53
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	42.0	292	0.9	0.2	5.1	6.3	6.5	5.6	1.72
*****	LIC MF Low Duration	41.4	1692	0.5	0.3	5.2	6.4	6.5	5.6	3.12

DEBT - SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Short Term	63.0	21450	1.1	0.5	4.7	7.0	7.0	6.3	9.89
*****	UTI Short Duration	33.0	2697	0.9	0.5	3.9	6.5	6.7	6.8	8.25
*****	Aditya Birla SL Short Term	49.5	7291	0.8	0.3	3.9	6.7	6.7	6.0	9.64
*****	Axis Short Duration	32.3	8955	0.9	0.4	4.4	7.1	6.9	6.0	7.46
*****	HDFC Short Term Debt	33.4	15463	0.7	0.4	4.2	6.9	7.0	6.1	9.17
*****	Nippon Ind Short Duration	55.0	7295	0.9	0.4	3.9	6.9	6.8	5.9	6.73
***	Bandhan Short Duration	59.6	8376	0.7	0.3	4.1	6.9	6.8	5.7	-
**	Baroda BNP Paribas Short Duration	30.3	260	0.9	0.4	3.5	6.5	6.5	5.6	1.94
***	HSBC Short Duration	27.5	3870	0.7	0.4	3.8	6.7	6.6	5.5	-
***	Kotak Bond Short Term	54.0	16487	1.1	0.4	3.4	6.4	6.4	5.5	-
***	Mirae Asset Short Duration	16.3	575	0.9	0.2	3.2	6.2	6.2	5.4	-
***	SBI Short Term Debt	33.4	13746	0.9	0.4	3.9	6.7	6.6	5.7	7.44
***	Sundaram Short Duration	46.1	188	0.8	0.3	4.0	6.7	6.6	5.8	2.67
**	Canara Robeco Short Duration	26.4	298	0.9	0.3	3.7	6.2	6.2	5.2	-
**	DSP Short Term	48.3	3245	0.8	0.3	3.5	6.4	6.4	5.4	-
**	Invesco India Short Duration	3698.8	883	0.9	0.3	3.5	6.4	6.5	5.3	3.15
**	Tata Short Term Bond	49.5	3142	1.0	0.3	3.2	6.1	6.1	5.3	-
*	Groww Short Term	2160.5	96	1.1	0.4	3.6	6.3	6.1	4.8	-
*	L I C MF Short Duration	15.1	138	1.4	0.7	3.3	6.2	6.2	5.0	7.84
-	Bank of India Short Term Income	27.8	272	1.0	0.5	3.8	7.1	6.7	10.0	5.90
-	Mah Manu Short Duration	13.3	86	1.1	0.3	4.0	6.5	6.5	5.4	13.83

Glitch delays CUET-UG at some centres; TCS-iON told to explain

FOLLOWING STEPS. Afternoon session timing revised; re-exam for 3,765 candidates to be scheduled

Meenakshi Verma Ambwani
New Delhi

The CUET-UG 2026, was delayed at some centres on Saturday due to a technical glitch, the National Testing Agency stated. It further stated, that most candidates were able to complete their exams once resumed after the issue was resolved. At the same time, the Agency said it will hold a rescheduled exam for about 3,765 candidates of the morning shift, who faced technical glitch-based delays, as a one-time measure. The agency has also said that the technical service provider, TCS-iON has been asked to conduct a root-cause analysis and submit a report. This comes on the heels of NEET-UG paper leak leading to its cancellation and discrepancies reported in the 12th CBSE exam results. In its updated statement, the NTA said on X that “earlier today, some centres faced a technical glitch that delayed the start of Shift 1...We know



DEEP FRUSTRATION. Students scheduled to take the Common University Entrance Test in the morning session at some centres reported that they were unable to take the examination due to the technical glitch **PH**

this was stressful, and we're sorry for the anxiety it caused. The technical service provider, TCS iON, has been asked to conduct a root-cause analysis and submit its report immediately.

RE-EXAM TO BE CONDUCTED “Most candidates (about 95 per cent) were able to complete their exam once it resumed. We understand that 3,765 candidates who were present and had completed biometric registration chose to leave

before the exam could restart. For these candidates, the NTA will hold a rescheduled examination as a one-time measure.” The NTA said it will announce the new date and details for these students.

GLITCH RESOLVED: TCS In an earlier post on X, the Agency had informed about the revised timings for the afternoon shift of the examination and said that the morning shift students were being given compensatory time so they are not disad-

vantaged. In a statement, K Krithivasan, CEO and MD, TCS, said, “A brief technical issue caused a delay of around two hours in the CUET-UG examination in the morning shift today. The issue was promptly identified and resolved by our technical teams, and the examination has since resumed without any impact to the sanctity of the exam. We regret the inconvenience. Our teams are actively monitoring all systems. We remain committed to working closely with NTA to ensure seamless conduct of the computer-based tests.”

Opposition leaders slammed the government for the issues faced by students. Congress leader Rahul Gandhi stated in a post on X, “NEET. CBSE. SSC. And today CUET. Four exams. One crore children. Not a single one was conducted with honesty... Modiji has completely ruined the entire education system. The generation whose future you are destroying is that same generation which will hold you accountable.”

Centre to waive cotton import duty till Oct 31 to reduce textile input costs

Shishir Sinha
New Delhi

The Finance Ministry on Saturday announced that it would exempt cotton imports from Customs duty for five months, starting June 1. As of now, the duty is 11 per cent.

“To augment the availability of cotton for the textile sector, the Centre has temporarily exempted all Customs duties on import of cotton from June 1, 2026, till October 31, 2026,” the Ministry said after the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs (CBIC) issued a notification. “The temporary duty exemption is expected to reduce input costs across the textile and apparel sector, thereby providing a targeted relief to manufacturers and consumers, while also keeping the interests of domestic farmers in mind,” the Ministry added.

The duty was last removed between August and Decem-

ber 2025, when steep US tariffs had begun hurting manufacturing and investments. The industry, which is the country's second-largest employment provider, requires stable access to high-quality cotton. In view of the persistent demand-supply gap, the government has announced an import duty exemption.

According to officials, the decision is expected to stabilise the input costs across the textile value chain, including yarn, fabric, garments, and made-ups, providing relief to manufacturers and consumers alike. This strategic intervention ensures that the textile sector remains globally competitive while safeguarding the interests of domestic cotton farmers. Most imports cater to specialised industrial requirements or brand-linked export contracts and do not replace domestic cotton.

BOOST EXPORTS Affordable, high-quality cotton strengthens India's posi-

tion in export markets, reviving orders for small and medium enterprises as well as export-oriented units. The textile-apparel value chain employs over 45 million people, and a stable cotton supply is crucial to prevent job losses and encourage industry growth. Consistent raw material supply expected to spur the production of higher-value fabrics and garments, supporting the government's ‘Make in India’ and domestic manufacturing goals, officials added.

They also said that farmers' interests are safeguarded through the minimum support price (MSP) mechanism operated by the Cotton Corporation of India Ltd. (CCI) For the 2026-27 marketing season, the Cabinet Committee on Economic Affairs increased the MSP for cotton by ₹557 per quintal. The new rates are fixed at ₹8,267 per quintal for medium-staple cotton and ₹8,667 per quintal for long-staple cotton.

AP rice heads to China via rail-road-sea route

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Nearly 2,700 tonnes of rice from Andhra Pradesh are on their way to China through a rail-road-sea logistics chain via Chennai Port, marking the revival of export cargo handling through BCN wagons at the Container Corporation of India's (CONCOR) Inland Container Depot (ICD) at Tondiarpet (near Chennai) after nearly five years.

The consignment, sourced from the Samalkot and Tanuku regions of Andhra Pradesh, was loaded in 42 BCN (Bogie Covered Wagon with Pneumatic Brakes) wagons and transported 575 km by rail to ICD Tondiarpet. There, the rice bags were directly stuffed into 105 twenty-foot equivalent unit (TEU) containers and will be transported about 5 km by road to the Chennai Port for shipment to China.

COST-EFFECTIVE CONCOR officials said the movement represents an important step towards promoting efficient, cost-effective and environmentally sustainable multimodal logistics solutions.

Traditionally, cargo arriving in BCN wagons is unloaded at railway goods sheds

and transported by trucks to warehouses for containerisation, involving multiple handling stages and additional transportation costs.

In contrast, the direct stuffing operation at ICD Tondiarpet enabled the cargo to be transferred straight from rail wagons into containers, completing the process within a day. This not only reduced handling costs and transit time but also minimised the risk of pilferage associated with multiple cargo movements.

“For bulk export cargo, rail transportation provides a cost-effective and sustainable alternative to conventional road movement, delivering tangible savings in overall logistics costs,” officials said.

According to a rice exporter associated with the shipment, the rail-road-sea movement reduced transportation cost by nearly 40 per cent compared with the conventional road-sea route.

The revival comes amid a strong rebound in India's rice exports. Rice export restrictions imposed during 2022-23 to contain domestic food inflation had reduced bulk cargo movements. However, record harvests improved domestic stocks and the government gradually relaxed and eventually lifted export curbs by 2025.

Customs system outage hits courier shipments

Aneesh Phadnis
Mumbai

An outage in the Customs Department's Express Cargo Clearance System (ECCS) since Thursday evening has disrupted international courier shipments from major airports across the country.

Courier companies use the ECCS to file details such as the bill of entry or shipping bill to obtain Customs clearance for imports and exports, respectively.

Details about consignor, consignee

and product description are submitted through the online platform.

2ND OUTAGE THIS MONTH

The outage, second this month, was reported on Thursday evening. No Customs clearance meant missed flight connections and delivery delays for importers and exporters. On average, airports handle around 40,000 international courier shipments daily including exports and imports.

SWITCH TO MANUAL

Following industry complaints, the Central Board of Indirect Taxes and

Customs on Saturday instructed all the field units to switch to the manual mode. “In order to ensure continuity of trade and to avoid disruption in movement of time sensitive consignments, all field formations are instructed to follow manual processing and clearance till ECCS becomes functional,” CBIC wrote to Customs Department commissioners across the country.

“While there will be delays, the Department has taken effective step to keep goods and shipments moving,” said Express Industry Council of India CEO Vijay Kumar.

DK Shivakumar elected CLP leader, set to take oath as Karnataka CM on June 3

Our Bureau
Bengaluru

Karnataka Deputy Chief Minister DK Shivakumar was on Saturday unanimously elected the new leader of the Congress Legislature Party (CLP), clearing the way for him to take over as the State's next Chief Minister on June 3.

The announcement came at a meeting of Congress legislators at the Vidhana Soudha, where the outgoing Chief Minister, Siddaramaiah, proposed Shivakumar's name for the top post. The proposal was backed by party legislators, formal-

ising the leadership transition in the State.

Shivakumar's elevation follows Siddaramaiah's resignation, which was accepted by Governor Thaaawardhand Gehlot on Friday. Following the resignation, the Governor also dissolved the Council of Ministers, paving the way for the formation of a new government under Shivakumar's leadership.

The Congress Legislature Party meeting was attended by party MLAs and overseen by senior All India Congress Committee leaders KC Venugopal and Randeep Singh Surjewala, who were tasked with ensuring a



Karnataka Congress President DK Shivakumar **PH**

smooth leadership transition.

Senior Congress leaders from across the country are likely to attend the swearing-in event on June 3, underscoring the significance of the leadership change in

one of the party's key States.

Sources indicated that while Shivakumar will assume office next week, a broader Cabinet expansion may be deferred until after the Rajya Sabha elections scheduled for June 17. Around 10 ministers are expected to be inducted in the next phase, as the party seeks to balance regional, caste and political considerations.

The leadership transition marks the culmination of the Congress' rotational power-sharing arrangement in Karnataka. Shivakumar's appointment is expected to usher in a new phase for the State government.

Veranda Learning clocks first full-year profit since listing

Our Bureau
Chennai

Veranda Learning reported its first full year profit in FY26 driven by an increase in enrolments in the commerce and government test prep verticals. Revenue from operations for FY26 increased 35 per cent to ₹482 crore supported by strong business momentum. Net profit came in at ₹130 crore for FY26, a sharp turnaround from net loss of ₹252 crore in FY25.

Revenue from operations for the quarter ended March 2026 (Q4FY26) stood at ₹132 crore, up 52 per cent y-o-y, while Q4 PAT almost doubled to ₹16 crore y-o-y.

The company saw a sharp decline in finance costs and other operating expenses, which also aided the profitability in Q4 and FY26. Q4 also saw an exceptional charge of around ₹4.12 crore which included a one-time charge towards additional premium paid and unamortised loan processing charges relating to premature redemption of NCDs; and gain/loss on sale of subsidiaries.

SEPARATE LISTING

Besides the turnaround, the company is now also closer



Suresh Kalpathi, ED and Chairman of Veranda Learning **BUJOY GHOSH**

to demerging and separately listing its commerce vertical, and now expects the final NCLT approval by mid-July.

“Importantly, we achieved a significant milestone in our corporate restructuring journey with the receipt of the first NCLT approval for the proposed commerce demerger. Further, shareholders approved the scheme through the successful completion of the EGM process,” Suresh S Kalpathi, Executive Director and Chairman of Veranda Learning Solutions, said.

Overall enrolments for FY26 grew 21 per cent to 2.6 lakh with collections increasing 40 per cent primarily driven by commerce and government test prep, Veranda Learning said in a statement.

Gujarat Energy takes war hit; FY26 net dips 48%

Avinash Nair
Ahmedabad



India's largest city gas distribution company, Gujarat Energy Ltd (formerly known as Gujarat Gas Ltd), on Saturday reported a 48 per cent decline in consolidated net profit to ₹1,678 crore for FY26 as the conflict in West Asia roiled global gas markets and weighed on its core city gas distribution and gas trading businesses.

The company, a major consumer of imported liquefied natural gas (LNG), reported a 14 per cent decline in consolidated revenue from operations to ₹24,425 crore in FY26.

The performance comes against the backdrop of continued volatility in global gas markets following the conflict in West Asia, a key source of LNG supplies for India.

PRICE PRESSURE

Higher gas prices and supply disruptions have impacted gas-linked businesses across the energy value chain, particularly city gas distribution and gas trading operations.

Pressure on the company's core businesses was visible during the year, with revenue from city gas distribution declining 7 per cent and gas trading revenue falling 19.5 per cent. Explora-

tion and production was the lone bright spot, posting a 13 per cent increase in revenue during FY26.

The power business reported a 46 per cent decline in revenue, while the re-gasification segment saw revenue fall 33 per cent.

Despite the weak annual performance, Gujarat Energy returned to profitability during the January-March quarter. The company reported a consolidated profit after tax of ₹152 crore compared with a loss of ₹158 crore in the corresponding quarter of FY25. Revenue from operations during the quarter, however, declined 8 per cent y-o-y.

businessline.

Disclaimer: Readers are requested to verify & make appropriate enquiries to satisfy themselves about the veracity of an advertisement before responding to any published in this newspaper. THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., the Publisher & Owner of this newspaper, does not vouch for the authenticity of any advertisement or advertiser or for any of the advertiser's products and/or services. In no event can the Owner, Publisher, Printer, Editor, Director/s, Employees of this newspaper/company be held responsible/liable in any manner whatsoever for any claims and/or damages for advertisements in this newspaper.



R.P.P. INFRA PROJECTS LIMITED

Reg. Off. : SF No. 454, Raghupathynaicken Palayam, Poondurai Main Road, Email : secretary@rppi.com, website: www.rppi.com
Erode - 638 002, Tamil Nadu Tel: +91 424 2284077, Fax: +91 424 2282077, CIN : L45201TZ1995PLC006113

EXTRACT OF STANDALONE AND CONSOLIDATED AUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS FOR THE YEAR ENDED 31.03.2026

S. No	Particulars	Standalone Quarter ended			Standalone Period ended		Consolidated Quarter Ended			Consolidated Period Ended	
		31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.12.2025	31.03.2025	31.03.2026	31.03.2025
		(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Unaudited)	(Audited)	(Audited)	(Audited)
1	Total Income from Operations	458.10	378.75	348.29	1501.58	1447.18	464.51	378.75	347.40	1518.19	1455.07
2	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-22.94	1.86	9.27	13.46	85.97	-22	1.85	8.38	13.54	85.79
3	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-22.94	1.86	9.27	11.08	85.97	-19.61	1.85	8.38	10.74	85.79
4	Net Profit/(Loss) for the period after Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)	-16.45	0.67	12.56	7.79	65.47	-13.13	0.67	11.67	7.45	65.29
5	Total Comprehensive Income for the period (Comprising Profit/(Loss) for the period (after Tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)	-16.48	0.73	11.21	7.78	65.37	-13.13	0.73	14.04	7.26	66.15
6	Paid up Equity Share Capital (Face Value of Rs.10/- Each)	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59	49.59
7	(a) Basic	-3.32	0.14	2.53	1.57	13.2	-2.65	0.14	2.35	1.5	13.17
	(b) Diluted	-3.32	0.14	2.53	1.57	13.2	-2.65	0.14	2.35	1.5	13.17

Note: The results along with the Audit Report have been posted on the company's website at <http://www.rppi.com>. The same can be accessed by scanning the QR code



Date: 30-05-2026
Place: Chennai

On behalf of Board of Directors
For RPP Infra Projects Limited

A.Nithya
Whole Time Director & Chief Financial Officer
DIN:00125357